



BSW

IIT DELHI

BLUE — — BOOK

BOARD FOR STUDENT WELFARE

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

This document is created and formatted by
Team BSW

Ideated by
Aniket Anand

Under the supervision of
Aniket Anand
Devesh Sharma
Amol Gupta

Aditya Singal
Agrima Agarwal
Aryan Rana
Anirudh Jassal
Aum Savaliya
Ditya Goel
Hardik Mahajan
Keshav Garg
Krishna Chadha
Satyarth Pandey

CONTENTS

QUANT / HFT / TRADING / MARKETS

• Jane Street	4
• Hudson River Trading	5
• Optiver	6
• IMC Trading	7
• Tower Research Capital Northmoore	8
• Tower Research Capital Limestone	9
• Graviton Research Capital	10
• Quantbox	11
• Virtu Financial	12
• Quadeye / Daksh Trading	13
• Quadeye	14
• Atlas Research	15
• DRW	16
• Da Vinci Derivatives	17
• WorldQuant	18
• BlackRock	19
• 26 Miles Capital	20
• NK Securities	21
• Goldman Sachs Securities / IB	22
• Goldman Sachs Global Markets	23
• Neo Wealth & Asset Management	24

TECH / SOFTWARE / SDE

• LinkedIn	25
• Microsoft	26
• Salesforce	27
• D.E. Shaw	28
• DE Shaw India	29
• Samsung Korea	30
• Sony Japan	31
• Glean Search Technologies	32
• DevRev	33
• Flipkart	34
• Pattern Technology	35

CONSULT / STRATEGY / INVESTMENT / BUSINESS

• McKinsey & Company	36
• BCG	37
• Bain & Company	38
• Strategy&	39
• Evercore	40
• WestBridge Capital	41
• Apollo Global Management	42
• Nomura Research Institute	43
• Kepler Cannon	44
• IvyCap Ventures	45
• Revolut	46
• Navi	47
• KPMG	48
• Accenture	49
• Nation With NaMo	50

CORE

• NVIDIA	51
• Qualcomm	52
• Texas Instruments	53
• Jaguar Land Rover TBSI	54
• Hindustan Unilever	55
• Piramal Pharma	56

ANALYTICS / DATA SCIENCE / AI-ML

• Mastercard	57
• American Express	58
• Barclays	59
• Eightfold	60
• Info Edge	61
• Accertify	62
• EXL Services	63
• AB InBev	64

JANE STREET



Personal Views

Savya Goel (B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering)

- For the Quant OA, they really judge your thought process, so make sure to write it down clearly it can be more important than the final answer. In the interviews, they expect you to collaborate and pick up on hints from the interviewer to incrementally build your strategy.

Arunabh Roy (B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering)

- Try to attend the SEE program, as it gives recruiters insight into you beforehand. For the SWE role, practice writing clean, modular code and be prepared to justify your design choices. Communication is just as important as your code.

Harshin Posina (B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering)

- Building and communicating your mathematical intuition is the most important factor. In interviews and discussions, you need to be able to speak confidently and continuously share your ideas and reasoning.

Vertical

- Quant Trader
- Quant Researcher
- Software Engineering Intern

Shortlist Criteria

While there is no official hard cutoff, shortlists for all roles heavily favour students with a **CGPA of 9.0 and above**. Performing well in Jane Street's winter **SEE Program** also provides a significant edge

Preparation Resources

- **Quant Puzzles:** The **Green Book** (Xinfeng Zhou), **Brainstellar**, and **50 Puzzling Problems in Probability** are essential. For more practice, you can use PuzzledQuant, TraderMath, or QuantGuide
- **Coding/DSA :** For the SWE role, general competitive programming preparation is sufficient.
- **Key Concepts :** Be thorough with probability, conditional probability, expectation, variance, and standard deviation.

Selection Procedure

- **Online Assessment (1 hour)**
 - **For SWE :** 2–3 standard coding problems (e.g., greedy, binary search). Emphasis on code quality, clarity, and modularity over complex algorithms.
 - **For Quant Trader/Researcher :** Two custom, multi-part problems by Jane Street; one on game theory (probability & EV for optimal strategy) and one on data analysis (trend prediction, missing data). Clear reasoning is critical.
- **Group Discussion (GD)**
 - **Format:** Casual, ~1 hour with a Jane Street employee and 3–4 candidates.
 - **For SWE :** Discuss a technical project; ask and answer questions on peers' work
 - **For Quant :** Light discussion on market-related topics (e.g., order books), focusing on communication and mathematical thinking
- **Interviews (2 rounds)**
 - **Format:** Two technical rounds, ~1 hour each; open-ended problems testing reasoning and real-world modeling.
 - **For SWE :** Conducted on Coderpad; assess clean coding, problem framing, and design justification
 - **For Quant:** Highly interactive; one round may involve simulating a betting strategy (Python); another centers on pandas-based analysis, explaining assumptions, logic, and conclusions

HUDSON RIVER TRADING

5



Personal Views

- Rajat Soni B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering
- Develop strong C++ experience and good implementation skills. A surprisingly important skill is a fast typing speed for the text-based GD rounds.
- Do not use any LLMs during practice, as it will damage your implementation ability.
- Learn OOPS in-depth, particularly in C++, as it's a must for most HFTs.
- Practice Competitive Programming and get basic data structures and algorithms into your muscle memory.

Positions Offered

Quant

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 9.0**

Preparation Resources

1. **DSA:** Codeforces, USACO guide, CP Algorithms
2. **OOPS:** LearnCPP.com, The Cherno C++ playlist on YouTube
3. **OS/CN:** GeeksforGeeks for a basic overview

How to Stand Out:

1. **Develop strong C++ implementation skills and a deep understanding of OOPS**
2. **Practice competitive programming consistently and learn touch-typing for speed in the unique text-based interviews**
3. **Gain a foundational knowledge of Operating Systems and Computer**

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Online Written Test

- Duration: 2 hours
- Structure:
 - 3 Competitive Programming questions
 - 1 OOPs implementation problem
- Focus on algorithmic thinking and correct implementation.

Stage 2: Interviews

- Total Rounds: 4
- Duration: ~45 minutes each

Round 1 & 2: Silent Text-Based GDs

- Conducted via chat (no speaking)
- Focus on:
 - CS fundamentals
 - Implementation-based discussions

Round 3: DSA Round

- Hard problem based on C++ STL
- Tested depth in data structures and problem-solving.

Round 4: System Design Round

- Covered:
 - Operating Systems (OS)
 - Computer Networks (CN)
 - Advanced C++ concepts
- Emphasis on design thinking and core systems knowledge.

OPTIVER



Personal Views

- Aniket Gupta-M.Tech, Mathematics and Computing
- You don't need super advanced probability theory for this role. It's way more important to be quick with your analysis, do fast mental math, and think about long-term strategies.
- Clearly explain your thought process out loud without hesitating, as they observe every step you take in the GD and interviews. What helped me was being able to find an effective strategy on the spot quickly.

Positions Offered

Quantitative Trading Intern

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA Criteria:** The initial shortlisting was likely based on a hard criterion of **8.4+ CGPA**.

Preparation Resources

- **Quant Puzzles:** **Brainstellar**, the **Green Book** (Xinfeng Zhou), **QuantGuide**, **Fifty Problems in Probability**, **PuzzledQuant**, and the **Intern Prep Series** are recommended.
- **Software Prep:** **Codeforces**, **Leetcode**, and the **CSES problem set** are useful for practice.

Selection Procedure

- **Online Assessment:** There were two online tests, both with negative marking (+1/-1). One involved solving 26 sequences in 25 minutes, and the other had 30 probability problems, each with a 90-second time limit.
- **Group Discussion:** In groups of 5, candidates were given a trading scenario with constraints and resources. The main focus was on collaborative problem-solving and clearly explaining your group's strategy to the interviewer, rather than just working alone.
- **Interviews (2 rounds):** The first round was technical, where you had to create and apply betting strategies to markets based on dice, cards, and coins. The second was a behavioural/HR round with questions about personal experiences and how you'd react in certain scenarios.

IMC TRADING



Personal Views

- **Nihal Popat** *B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering*
- Treat your interviews like a chill discussion, not an interrogation. Always talk through your thought process they care more about *how* you think than getting the perfect answer instantly.
- **Sabhya Khurana** *B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering*
- You have to be aggressive in the GDs jump in and make trades without waiting. Be confident in your math during interviews, as they will test you by acting doubtful.
- Seriously, don't sleep on your extra-curriculars. The soft skills you get from them are what really make you stand out.

Vertical

Roles Offered: Software Development Engineer (SDE), Trading Intern

Shortlist Criteria

CGPA Criteria: A hard cutoff of **8.0** for the Trading Intern online test; CV/CG shortlisting is used for the SDE role.

Preparation Resources

- **Recommended Resources:**
 - **Quant Puzzles:** **PuzzledQuant**, **Brainstellar Puzzles**, and the **Green Book** by Xinfeng Zhou are highly recommended.
 - **Coding/DSA:** **CSES** and **Codeforces** are valuable for practice. The **DevClub Intern Prep Series** is a comprehensive resource for both roles.
 - **Trading Specific:** Practice **market-making simulations** with peers and use the **IITD Case Compendium** for guesstimates.
- **How to Stand Out:**
 - **Communication is critical.** Treat interviews as open discussions, not interrogations, and clearly articulate your thought process.
 - **Be proactive and confident.** In GDs, be active, take initiative in market-making games, and be confident in your calculations.
 - **Be honest.** It's better to admit when you don't know something. Interviewers are more interested in your reasoning and thinking skills.
 - **Leverage soft skills.** Build a rapport with your interviewers and highlight personality traits developed through extracurriculars to stand out.

Selection Procedure

- The selection process differs significantly based on the role:
- **For the SDE Role:**
 - **Online Assessment:** A 2-hour test with two moderate DSA questions, focusing on Dynamic Programming and Graphs.
 - **Interviews:** The process includes a 3-hour Group Discussion focused on explaining and optimizing C++ OOPS code, a 2-hour technical round combining theoretical discussion and coding, and a final 30-minute HR interview.
- **For the Trading Intern Role:**
 - **Online Assessment:** Two separate tests—a 1.5-hour "Brainlympics" test with memory and reaction-time games, and a 1.5-hour HackeRank test with probability puzzles, pattern recognition, and one coding problem.
 - **Interviews:** This includes a Group Discussion with trade strategy analysis and a market-making game, followed by three pre-interview rounds covering trading (guesstimates), quant (strategy), and HR6. The final interview on Day 1 is often a formality.

TOWER RESEARCH CAPITAL (NORTHMOORE)



Personal Views

- Academic Excellence: Maintain a high CGPA and actively strive to increase it.
- Consistent CP Practice: Practice Competitive Programming consistently and do not limit preparation to the final two months before placement.
- Clarity in Core Subjects: Ensure that the fundamentals, particularly from courses like MTL106 (Probability/Statistics), are thoroughly understood.
- Effective Use of Time: The summer break provides sufficient time to focus on quantitative questions (puzzles, probabilities, etc.).
- Group Discussion (GD) Engagement: If a GD is part of the process, active participation and maintaining a clear, logical chain of thought are crucial for standing out.
- Interview Presence: Exhibit strong "presence of mind" during the interview, demonstrating quick thinking and adaptability.
- Peer Group Collaboration: Cultivate a strong peer group and actively discuss doubts and challenging problems with them.

Profiles Offered

**Quantitative Researcher
& Quantitative Developer**

Shortlist Criteria

- A minimum CGPA of 9.0 was reported for CV shortlisting

Preparation Resources

Primary Repository:

Use <https://github.com/devclub-iitd/SDE-Prep> for comprehensive Quant and SDE preparation.

Competitive Programming:

Solve ~150–200 LeetCode problems and cover key CSES sections (graphs, trees, DP, sorting/searching).

C++ Fundamentals:

Revise core C++ topics using the Placements-2024 repo and standard resources like YouTube or GeeksforGeeks.

Quant Preparation:

Practice puzzles from Brainstellar, Green Book (Xinfeng Zhou), Peter Winkler, 50 Challenging Problems in Probability, and Quant Guide.

Selection Procedure

• Written Tests (Online Test):

- Format: A 2-hour test conducted on HackerRank.
- Content:
 - 20 Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs): Focused on basic Computer Science fundamentals.
 - 3 Coding Questions: The difficulty was comparable to Codeforces 2000–2200 level problems.

• Interviews: The process involved multiple interview rounds (in this case, three rounds were conducted).

- **Round 1 (Relatively Lighter):** Focused on basic C++ fundamentals and a discussion of the candidate's summer internship project. A practical application question was asked, specifically relating to multithreading to find the sum of an array in $O(\log n)$, followed by an algorithmic coding request.
- **Round 2 and 3 (Technical Depth):** These rounds heavily focused on brain teasers and probability questions. The problems were entirely new (unseen in standard preparation materials).
- **Evaluation Focus:** The key factor in these rounds was the candidate's ability to effectively catch up on and incorporate the hints provided by the interviewer to progress toward the solution. The process is highly interactive and tests on-the-spot problem-solving and adaptability.

TOWER RESEARCH CAPITAL (LIMESTONE)



Personal Views

- **Extensive Quant Practice:** Extensive and consistent practice on quantitative problems throughout the summer break is highly beneficial and helps you stand out, especially in interviews, as the coding rounds tend to be similar for most candidates.
- **Internship Discussion:** Be prepared to discuss your summer internship project in significant detail, as it may occupy a considerable amount of time during the interview.
- **Consistency is Key:** The overall process emphasizes consistency. Preparation starting from zero during the 8 weeks of the summer break is sufficient, provided the effort is consistent and focused on continuous improvement.

Profiles Offered

Quantitative Trading /
High-Frequency Trading

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA:** No CGPA but was based on Department Rank

Preparation Resources

- **Green Book (XinFeng Zhou)** – A great starting point for quant interview fundamentals, especially probability and puzzles.
- **QuantGuide.io** – Useful for building quantitative intuition through a wide range of problems.
- **Peter Winkler – Mathematical Puzzles** – A must-do resource; many OA/interview questions are directly inspired. Study selectively.
- **Codeforces & LeetCode** – Core platforms for DSA and CP; prioritize LeetCode Hard problems.
- **C++ Resources** – Use CppCon talks and cppreference.com for deep C++ understanding.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1 - Online Written Test

- Two Sections:
 - **Coding:** 2 extremely difficult CP/Math-style problems; most candidates achieved only partial solutions.
 - **Quant:** 14–15 questions covering probability (MTL106-level) and tricky quantitative puzzles.
- Overall difficulty was high and well-balanced.

Stage 2 - Group Discussion (GD)

- Duration: ~1.5 hours
- Theme: Betting strategies
- Discussion evolved from a specific problem to broader concepts, culminating in Kelly's Criterion.
- Focus on communication, logical reasoning, and collaborative thinking.

Stage 3 - Technical Interview

- Duration: ~1 hour
- Structure:
 - **Coding:** In-depth discussion on a challenging graph-based CP problem (approach-focused).
 - **Quant:** Generic quantitative puzzles.
 - **Follow-up:** Questions linked to topics discussed in the GD.
- Emphasis on problem-solving approach and conceptual clarity.

GRAVITON RESEARCH CAPITAL



Personal Views

- Anonymous (B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering)
- To stand out here, you need to be strong in both competitive programming and core CS fundamentals, especially computer architecture.
- M.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering
- Be thorough with DSA, but don't neglect your computer architecture fundamentals and understanding how your code actually runs at a system level. In the interview, make sure you're constantly thinking out loud and explaining your approach clearly.

Vertical

Quant

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 8 (Hard Cutoff)**

Preparation Resources

1. Competitive Programming:

Regular practice on Codeforces is essential. The USACO Gold guide and CSES problem set are also highly recommended.

2. **C++ and Systems:** learncpp.com is a great resource for C++ fundamentals. The ANCC/DevClub Prep Series is useful for systems preparation

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Pen-and-Paper Test

- **Format: IIT-style written exam**
- Coverage:
 - Competitive Programming: 3 difficult problems (DP, graphs, greedy, number theory)
 - Algorithm design and proof required
 - CS Fundamentals:
 - OOPs (virtual functions, constructors)
 - Computer Architecture (pipelining)
 - Digital Logic (flip-flops, gates)

Stage 2: Technical Interviews (2–3 Rounds)

For SWE

- Focus on:
 - DSA
 - Core CS
- Difficulty: Medium CP (graphs/trees) to very hard DP problems.

For Systems / ULL

- Deep focus on:
 - CPU pipelining
 - Branch prediction
 - Implementing C++ internals (e.g., shared_ptr)
 - System-level bottleneck analysis

Stage 3: HR Round (Optional)

- Short and culture-focused
- Often non-evaluative

QUANTBOX



Personal Views

- **Structured Interaction and Communication:** Instead of treating the interview as a simple question-and-answer session, engage the interviewer in a discussion. Continuously convey your thought process and various approaches for solving the problem. This clear communication allows the interviewer to understand your analytical method and provides opportunities for them to offer crucial hints.
- **Collaborative Learning:** Regularly discuss challenging or interesting questions with peers. This collaborative approach is highly effective for learning new methods, different perspectives, and alternative approaches to problem-solving, which significantly aids in preparation.

Vertical

Quantitative Trading / Finance

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 8.5 (hard cutoff)**

Preparation Resources

- **Peter Winkler (Mathematical Puzzles and Problems)**
- **50 Challenging Problems in Probability (F. Mosteller)**
- **Xin Feng Zhou (Quantitative Interview Preparation)**
- **Brainstellar (Puzzles and Interview Questions)**
- **PuzzledQuant (Platform for Quant Puzzles)**

Selection Procedure

Stage 1 - Online Written Test

- Duration: 120 minutes
- Sections:
 - Quantitative Aptitude (6 high-quality, challenging problems)
 - Competitive Programming (exceptionally difficult)
 - C++
 - Core Computer Science
- Core & C++ sections were fast-paced MCQs testing conceptual depth and speed.

Stage 2 - Offline Pen-and-Paper Test

- Shortlisting based on online test performance and CV.
- Separate 1-hour papers for Quant and Core roles.

Quant Paper

- 4 extremely challenging problems
- Emphasis on problem-solving approach and thought process over final answers.

Core Paper

- Entirely Systems and C++ based
- Purely conceptual, no CP
- Designed to test deep understanding of core fundamentals.

Stage 3 - Technical Interviews

- Total Rounds: 4
- Duration: ~4.5 hours in total
- Focus Areas:
 - High-level Quantitative problem-solving (harder than written tests)
 - Structured approach and logical reasoning
 - Ability to build upon interviewer hints
 - Converging toward correct conclusions
- Questions were novel, highly demanding, and discussion-driven (typically 4–10 per candidate).

VIRTU FINANCIAL



Personal Views

- **Speed and Accuracy:** Success in the interview process, particularly the initial puzzle rounds, requires both speed and accuracy in problem-solving.
- **Clarity in Communication:** Being clear and articulate in communication is paramount. Interviewers assess not just the solution, but how well you convey your thought process, especially when solving problems mentally.
- **Market Making Practice:** It is highly recommended to practice market making scenarios, as this is a specific type of problem that may appear in the later rounds (e.g., justifying spreads, setting ranges, and making assumptions based on guesstimates).

Profiles Offered

Quantitative Trading

Shortlist Criteria

- A strict minimum CGPA of 9.0 was required for initial shortlisting to the Online Assessment.

Preparation Resources

- **CP & DSA:** Codeforces (target 1700+), LeetCode Hard, and CP-algorithms.
- **Quant Prep:** Brainstellar and Xin Feng Zhou (Green Book)—complete thoroughly; use QuantGuide.
- **Core Courses:** Strong grasp of MTL106 (Probability/Statistics) and COL106 (DSA).
- **Special Focus:** Practice market-making problems.
- **Videos:** Follow the QuantProf YouTube channel.

Selection Procedure

- **Written Tests (Online Test):**
- **Format:** A 1-hour HackerRank exam.
- **Content:** Consisted of 5 very easy Competitive Programming (CP) questions, which were roughly at the 800 Codeforces difficulty level.
- **Interviews (Buddy Rounds):** A series of five consecutive, fast-paced rounds were conducted to evaluate different skills:
- **Fast Puzzle Round (30 minutes):** Focused on medium-level probability puzzles to be solved mentally and quickly. This round tested problem-solving speed and communication clarity.
- **Strategy Problem Round (20 minutes):** Centered on a single strategy problem where the candidate had to devise an optimal solution.
- **Detailed Probability Round (30 minutes):** Involved more detailed probability questions that required structured thinking and a step-by-step approach.
- **Market Making/Guesstimate Round (10 minutes):** A quick round on market making, requiring the candidate to make assumptions, set appropriate price ranges, and justify their bid-ask spread based on a guesstimate scenario.
- **HR Round (10 minutes):** A brief round focused on assessing fit, motivation, and general personal background.

QUADEYE (DAKSH TRADING)



Personal Views

- **Clarity of Approach and Quick Thinking:** The ability to think quickly and present a clear, structured approach to a problem is crucial. Demonstrate that you can properly assess the question and steer your thoughts logically, even if the final solution is not immediately apparent or complete.
- **Confidence and Initiative:** Confidence is key in all interview rounds. Take the initiative, start by clearly stating the objective and your initial idea (even if incomplete), and explain the why behind your steps. Interviewers value candidates who maintain a clear problem-solving mindset and embrace the hints provided to move forward.
- **Stay Logical and Focused:** Ensure your thought process is logical throughout the discussion. Preparation should be thorough, and it is vital to stay calm and avoid panicking during the interview.

Profiles Offered

Quantitative Trading / Financial

Markets Role: Quantitative Trader

Shortlist Criteria

- **No specific hard CGPA criterion was reported, but the process starts with CV shortlisting, implying a strong academic profile (the reported CGPA was 9.38)**

Preparation Resources

- **Brainstellar (Puzzles and Interview Questions)**
- **Puzzled Quant (Platform for Quant Puzzles)**
- **Striver's A2Z DSA Sheet / Striver (LeetCode) (For Data Structures and Algorithms)**
- **Quant Guide (Recommended if time allows)**

Selection Procedure

- **Written Tests (Online Test):**
 - **Pre-requisite: Candidates** must clear CV shortlisting to be eligible for the test.
 - **Format:** The test consisted of 9 questions to be completed in 45 minutes.
 - **Content:** Questions were primarily puzzle and mathematics-based, covering topics like combinatorics and logical reasoning.
- **Interviews:** All interview rounds were conducted online.
 - **English Assessment:** Given the role is based in Hong Kong, the interviews assess your English speaking and communication skills.
 - **Round 1:** Focused on a mix of Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA) questions and Brainstellar-type puzzles.
 - **Round 2 & 3:** These subsequent rounds concentrated on logical reasoning questions and more complex brain teasers, including strategy-based problems.
 - **HR Round:** There was no dedicated HR round reported.

QUADEYE



Personal Views

- **Interview Performance:** The ability to answer questions correctly and quickly is a major factor, especially when competing with candidates who have a higher CGPA or better Department Rank.
- **Strong Quant CV:** Cultivate a very strong Quantitative CV with projects and coursework that align directly with topics and skills valued by quant firms (e.g., probability, statistics, specialized algorithms).
- **Communication Skills:** Do not just prepare for the technical rounds; you must practice your speaking skills as well. Clear and effective communication is essential.
- **Observation on OAs:** Be aware that Indian Quant Online Assessments (OAs) are relatively tougher than Foreign Quant OAs, but are still solvable with sufficient preparation. Foreign Quant OAs may be easier, but the Group Discussions (GDs) and interviews can feel more "random" or unpredictable.

Profiles Offered

Quantitative Trading

Shortlist Criteria

Heavily based on Department Rank (DR), implying a very high academic standing (the reported CGPA was 9.27)

Preparation Resources

- **Quantguide:** Highly recommended as it covers almost everything necessary for preparation.
- **General Quant Resources:**
- **50 Challenging Problems in Probability**
- **Brainstellar (Puzzles and Interview Questions)**

Selection Procedure

- **Written Tests:** Not explicitly detailed, but implied by the "CV/CG Shortlisting (at any stage)" being listed. The senior's advice section suggests awareness of the relative difficulty of Indian vs. Foreign Quant OAs.
- **Interviews:** All interview rounds were conducted online.
- **Format:** Consisted of 2 technical interview rounds. No dedicated HR round was identified.
- **Content:** Focused on typical quant questions, specifically emphasizing probability and statistics. The questions were described as "simple" in nature (implying a focus on conceptual clarity and fundamental understanding).

ATLAS RESEARCH



Personal Views

Anonymous (M.Tech, Mathematics and Computing)

- The key is to build very strong fundamentals in probability and to practice problem-solving consistently. The interview puzzles often have elegant solutions, so a solid foundation is essential.

Anonymous (B.Tech, Computer Science)

- Your performance in the online assessment is a huge factor; doing extremely well can pretty much guarantee an offer and might even let you skip an interview round.
- Start your competitive programming practice as early as possible. You can start dedicated quant prep in the summer before the intern season, but CP needs more time.

Profiles Offered

Quantitative Researcher

Quantitative Trader

Shortlist Criteria

- A hard cutoff of **8.5 CGPA** was used for shortlisting before the first online test.

Preparation Resources

- Quant: The Green Book (Xinfeng Zhou), Brainstellar, 50 Problems in Probability, Heard on the Street, and Aniruddha Deb's quant prep guide are recommended.
- Competitive Programming: Regular participation in contests on Codeforces (CF) and CodeChef (CC) is crucial.

Selection Procedure

- **Online Test:** The first stage test was a multi selection online test on HackerRank. It consisted of:
 - **Competitive Programming(CP):** 3 extremely difficult questions (rated 1800-2000+).
 - **Quant:** 6 moderately difficult questions covering probability, discrete maths and integration.
 - **OOPs/Systems:** A section for SWE/Traders Role.
 - Candidates for the QR role attempted the Quant and CP section, while SWE/Trader candidates attempt CP and Systems.
- **Pen-and-Paper Test:** Shortlisted candidates then took a 90-minute written test with harder questions on Quant, CP, and OOPs.
- **Interviews (1-2 rounds) :**
 - The interviews were technical. The QR role interview involved numerous math puzzles and a CV discussion, lasting up to 90 minutes.
 - The Trader/SWE role focused more on CP problems.
 - A strong performance in online test is critical; some candidates with exceptional scores in the didn't had to sit for the second round of interview

DRW



Personal Views

Anonymous (B.Tech + M.Tech. Mathematics and Computing)

- Having some prior finance knowledge really helps you stand out.
- My advice is to keep your preparation broad and not just focus on one specific company's process. A good generic, quant prep will cover you for most firms.

Profiles Offered

Quant Trader Intern

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA Criteria:** No hard cutoff mentioned, but the initial CV shortlisting for the test is mostly CGPA-based.

Preparation Resources

- **Quant Puzzles:** The **Green Book** (Xinfeng Zhou) and **PuzzleQuant** are recommended
- **Statistics:** Knowledge from relevant courses, such as MTL-782, is beneficial.

Selection Procedure

Online Test:

- After CV shortlisting, candidates appear for an online test consisting of quantitative questions based on arithmetic and logical reasoning. Accuracy is very important in this round, as most questions need to be answered correctly to move forward.

Group Discussion (GD):

- The GD round mainly focuses on assessing financial awareness and intuition. It also evaluates communication skills, confidence, and the ability to work in a team.

Interviews (3 Rounds):

- Candidates who clear the GD proceed to three interview rounds. These cover topics such as puzzles, probability, statistics, and data mining. The interviews test both conceptual knowledge and problem-solving skills, along with overall personality.

DA VINCI DERIVATIVES



Personal Views

Anonymous (B.Tech. Computer Science)

- The whole process is about how fast you can think and do math, not how many problems you've solved before. What helped me was being quick with calculations and clearly explaining my intuition and thought process out loud.
- My main advice is to just stay calm during the GDs. The best way to prep is to solve a wide variety of quant problems to build up your mathematical intuition. company's process. A good generic, quant prep will cover you for most firms

Profiles Offered

Quant Trader Intern

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA Criteria:** No hard cutoff mentioned, but the initial CV shortlisting for the test is mostly CGPA-based.

Preparation Resources

- No specific resources were mentioned for preparation, as the selection process mainly focused on testing raw problem-solving speed and natural intuition rather than familiarity with particular questions or predefined problem sets. Candidates were expected to rely on their basic aptitude, quick thinking, and analytical ability instead of memorized concepts or standard solutions.

Selection Procedure

- **Online Assessment:** The first stage was a speed-based test with multiple math and logic questions. The problems were relatively easy, but the main challenge was the time constraint.
- **Group Discussions (3 rounds):** This was the primary selection method, designed to filter candidates down from 36 to the final few. Each round focused on a different problem type, and a key element was making a market around your estimated answers.
 - Round 1: A math-based estimation problem.
 - Round 2: A dice-based probability problem requiring heavy and fast calculation.
 - Round 3: A card-based dynamic programming problem that served as a direct elimination round.
- **Interview:** The interview round was mainly a formality, as the selection was already made through the GDs.

WORLDQUANT



Personal Views

- **Interview Confidence:** Answering questions confidently is crucial for making a positive impression.
- **CV Readiness:** Prepare thoroughly and be ready to explain every point on your CV with depth and clarity.
- **Consistent Preparation:** Regular practice over the summer helps you clear initial assessments and builds confidence through shortlisting.
- **Placement Day Attitude:** Stay calm and optimistic. Be aware of unethical hiring practices and be ready to decide whether to proceed or explore other opportunities.

Positions Offered

Quant Researcher intern

Shortlist Criteria

No official cut-off, but a CGPA of 8.3+ is typically observed for shortlisting.

Preparation Resources

Quant Resources:

- quantguide.io, Puzzledquant, 50 Challenging Problems in Probability (F. Mosteller), Xin Feng Zhou's Green Book (Specifically for probability topics)

Coding Resources (DSA/CP):

- LeetCode, CP-algorithms, Codeforces, InterviewBit, HackerRank

Selection Procedure

• Written Tests (Online Assessment):

- **Format:** The assessment consisted of 24 questions to be solved in 2 hours.
- **Difficulty:** Problems were noted to be on the difficult side.
- **Benchmark:** A safe score was estimated to be 15 or more questions correctly solved.

• Interviews: Candidates typically go through 2 to 3 rounds, depending on scheduling feasibility.

- **Round 1 (First Interview):** Focused predominantly on probability and core mathematics concepts.
- **Round 2 (Subsequent Interviews):** This round was more all-around, covering a mix of probability, general statistics, and sometimes a simple coding question (especially if the candidate highlights coding proficiency in their CV). This round was described as feeling more like a discussion, contributing to comfort and confidence.
- **Evaluation Weight:** It was felt that the final interview round mattered significantly in the selection decision

BLACK ROCK



Personal Views

Anonymous (B.Tech, Electrical Engineering)

- For quant roles at asset management firms like BlackRock, you need more than just CP and probability; some finance and ML knowledge is also required.
- A targeted CV that shows a clear interest in the domain helps a lot. Try to balance academics with relevant extracurriculars. And in interviews, communicating your ideas clearly and confidently is crucial.
- Know your projects inside and out, especially the "why" behind your decisions. Master your CV. Practice explaining every point multiple times.
- Having a relevant "spike", like my experience with WorldQuant, becomes a major talking point and sets you apart. Research the company and ask questions at the end of interview to show genuine interest.

Profiles Offered

Quantitative Researcher

Quantitative Trader

AI & ML Engineer

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA Criteria:** For the Quant role, an **8.0+ CGPA** was likely preferred for CV shortlisting. For the AI & ML role, there was no hard CGPA criteria; shortlisting was based on the online test and resume

Preparation Resources

- **Quant/Math:** Brainstellar, Green Book (Xinfeng Zhou), Puzzled Quant, and Fifty Challenging Problems in Probability are key resources.
- **DSA/CP:** LeetCode, Codeforces, and Striver's DSA sheets are recommended for practice.
- **ML/Stats:** CampusX's "100 Days of ML" playlist, Andrew Ng's CS229 lectures, and articles on GeeksforGeeks are useful for ML and stats concepts.
- **SQL:** Practice SQL questions on HackerRank.

Selection Procedure

• For Quant Modelling and Research

- **Shortlisting:** Based on CV, looking for a background in math, CS, and finance, with strong projects and ideally a research internship.
- **Interviews (2 rounds):**
 - Round 1 (Technical): Focused on ML projects from the CV, with extension questions and concepts like optimization. Also included a guesstimate and questions on LLMs.
 - Round 2 (Mixed HR/Technical): Covered technical topics like linear algebra and probability, with more questions on LLMs and standard HR questions.

• For AI & ML Engineers

- **Online Test:** A multi-section test covering Aptitude (numerical/verbal reasoning), Software Aptitude (flowchart-based problems), DSA (heavy focus on trees), and SQL (25 MCQs).
- **Interviews (1-2 rounds):** Both rounds were a mix of technical and HR, heavily grilling the CV.
 - Round 1 : Started with a deep dive into a project, followed by questions on challenges faced, model metrics, and technical skills (DSA, programming languages).
 - Round 2 : A senior-level interview focused on relevant quant experience (e.g., WorldQuant), alpha generation, portfolio diversification, and open-ended strategy questions.

26 MILES CAPITAL



Personal Views

Saksham Pratap Singh
Mathematics and Computing

- Your CGPA and test performance are the most important factors. Getting into external quant programs like the IMC Trading Launchpad also really helps and gives you something to talk about in interviews.
- My advice is to get genuinely interested in competitive programming and puzzle-solving. Regular practice with CP problems and puzzle books is usually enough for most quant tests. Having solid C++ skills and some ML projects on your resume is a big plus.

Profiles Offered

Quantitative Researcher

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7.5 (hard cutoff); 8.5+ preferred**

Preparation Resources

- **Programming:** Competitive Programmer's Handbook, CSES Problem Set, Codeforces, and a standard LeetCode sheet are recommended.
- **Mathematics:** A Practical Guide to Quantitative Finance Interviews (Green Book), Brainstellar, and revised notes from relevant math courses (like MTL106) are useful.
- **C++:** learncpp.com is suggested for building a strong foundation

Selection Procedure

Online Test (60 mins):

- The online test consisted of two competitive programming-style coding questions along with multiple-choice questions. The MCQs covered topics such as probability, mathematics, and basic finance. This round tested problem-solving skills, conceptual understanding, and the ability to manage time effectively under pressure.

Interviews (3 rounds):

- **Round 1 (Technical):** This round started with a deep dive into the CV and projects (especially ML). It was followed by challenging questions on probability (comparing distribution stability, finding stationary distribution) and a complex math puzzle requiring a greedy solution.
- **Round 2 (Technical):** A shorter round focused on finance-related questions, where the emphasis was on the thought process rather than prior knowledge.
- **Round 3 (HR):** This was a standard HR round with basic questions and further discussion about the CV



Personal Views

- Vaibhav Sharma - M.Tech, Mathematics and Computing
- A high CGPA is really important to get shortlisted for the interview. Once you're shortlisted, it's crucial to be confident and interact well with the interviewer, explaining your thought process clearly.
- Tanish Singh Khurana - B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering
- Don't just focus on competitive programming. CP will help you clear the OAs, but for SDE roles at quant firms, they grill you on **C++ fundamentals** in the interviews, so make sure your core concepts are solid.
- Abdul Haleem Ahmed - B.Tech and M.Tech, Mathematics and Computing
- Focus on cracking the online test, as your performance there can create a strong first impression on interviewers. Even for a quant role, they appreciate a deep knowledge of C++. Also, having a good peer group to discuss problems with really helps you learn to explain solutions clearly.

Vertical

Roles Offered: Quantitative Research Intern, Software Development Engineer (SDE)

Shortlist Criteria

CGPA Criteria: A hard CGPA cutoff is used for shortlisting. A minimum of **9.0** was required to be eligible for the SDE test, and shortlists for Quant Research heavily favored those with **9.3 or higher**.

Preparation Resources

- **Quant Puzzles:** The **Green Book** (Xinfeng Zhou), **Brainstellar**, **Puzzled Quant**, and **Heard on the Street** are the standard resources.
- **Coding/DSA:** **LeetCode**, **Codeforces**, **CSES Problem Set**, and **Striver's DSA sheet** are recommended for practice.
- **C++ Fundamentals:** **learncpp.com** is highly recommended for building a strong foundation in core C++ concepts, which is heavily tested.
- **Comprehensive Prep:** The **BSW Intern series** is noted as being very helpful.

Selection Procedure

- **Online Assessment:**
 - The test is roughly 90-120 minutes long and includes both coding and math/MCQ sections.
 - **For SDE:** The OA includes 2 competitive programming-style problems (DP, trees) and around 15 MCQs on C++ fundamentals, systems, and quant.
 - **For Quant Research:** The OA features 2 moderate-to-hard coding questions (e.g., binary search, bitmasking DP) and about 15 math puzzles, some of which also test C++ concepts.
- **Interviews (1-2 rounds):**
 - **For SDE:** The process consists of two rounds. The first technical round (40 mins) dives deep into a resume project and core C++ concepts (pointers, stack vs. heap, inheritance), followed by an HR round (10 mins) with the same interviewer.
 - **For Quant Research:** There is typically a single technical round (30-45 mins). The interview covers a mix of probability puzzles, DSA questions (graphs), and surprisingly deep C++ concepts (OOPs, const, static). This is immediately followed by an HR round covering situational questions.

GOLDMAN SACHS



Personal Views

- **In-Depth Project Knowledge:** You must have complete expertise in everything written on your CV. If you have unique technical projects (e.g., a Compiler or Interpreter), be prepared for a deep dive, as Goldman often uses proprietary systems like Slang (their internal programming language) and highly values systems knowledge.
- **Active Engagement:** Don't just solve the problem; be involved with the interviewer. Ask clarifying questions regarding constraints and edge cases before you begin.
- **Clear Communication:** Strong communication and the ability to convey your ideas clearly are vital. Interviewers may try to trick or mislead you to test your confidence; stay firm in your logical approach if you are certain.
- **Handle Hints Gracefully:** If you get stuck, proactively ask for hints. You are being judged on your problem-solving process and interest in the role, not just the final solution.

Positions Offered

**Investment Banking /
Global Markets**

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA:8.45**

Preparation Resources

1. **Strivers DSA Sheet:** takeuforward.org (A-Z course recommended).
2. **Intern-Prep Series (Dev-Club IITD):** github.com/devclub-iitd.
3. **CP-Algorithms:** cp-algorithms.com (Standard for advanced algorithm concepts).
4. **Competitive Programmer's Handbook:** cses.fi/book/book.pdf.
5. **General Coding Practice:** LeetCode (focusing on Graphs, DP, Trees, Binary Search, and Greedy).

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Online Written Test

- Duration: 60 minutes
- Format: Single assessment with 3 cumulative, non-timed sections (free navigation).

Sections

- General Maths (5 MCQs): Geometry, Probability, PnC, Number Theory
- Coding (3 Questions): Recursion, Binary Search, 2D Dynamic Programming, Greedy
- Core Programming (5 MCQs): OOPs, debugging, output prediction, time complexity

Stage 2: Technical Interviews - 3 Rounds

Round 1: DSA & Strings

- **Problems on:**
 - Interleaving strings (recursion + memoization)
 - BST construction from sequences
 - Relative sequence construction
- Concepts discussed: hashing, maps, deep vs shallow copy in strings
- Pseudo-code written on paper.

Round 2: Algorithms & Practical CS

- CV project discussion followed by algorithmic questions.
- Problems similar to Rainwater Trapping.
- Dry-running:
 - BFS
 - Dijkstra's algorithm
- Included 2 easy logical puzzles.

Round 3: Core Projects Deep Dive

- Heavy emphasis on core systems/projects.
- ~25 minutes spent discussing a DSL Compiler & Interpreter built from scratch.
- Reflects Goldman Sachs' focus on strong fundamentals and programming language internals (due to use of proprietary languages like Slang).

GOLDMAN SACHS



Personal Views

- **Machine Learning Background:** Previous internships or projects in Machine Learning (ML) act as a significant differentiator for "Strat" roles, as the work often involves building predictive models.
- **Mathematical Fluency:** Beyond just knowing formulas, practice explaining variants of common probability questions. The goal is to show the interviewer that you can adapt your logic when the constraints change.
- **Focus on Fundamentals:** Consistent practice is essential. This role bridges the gap between pure coding and mathematical research, so balance your time between CP and probability.

Positions Offered

**Securities / Investment
Banking**

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 8.4**

Preparation Resources

1. **DSA Preparation:** Striver's A2Z Sheet (Comprehensive for standard patterns).
2. **Quantitative Finance/Probability:** The Green Book (Xin Feng Zhou) and 50 Challenging Problems in Probability.
3. **Problem Solving:** CSES Problem Set (Focused on core algorithms).
4. **Interview Specifics:** Quantguide (Valuable for role-specific intuition).

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Online Written Test

- **Format:** Single comprehensive online assessment
- **Content:**
 - Competitive Programming (CP): Algorithmic efficiency-focused coding questions
 - Probability
 - Logical Reasoning
- Designed to test both mathematical thinking and core coding fundamentals.

Stage 2: Technical Interviews

- Total Rounds: 3
- No separate HR round reported.

Round 1: Probability & Mathematics

- Variants of standard probability problems
- Emphasis on conceptual understanding rather than memorized formulas.

Round 2: Coding & Data Structures

- Pure DSA-focused round
- Stack-based problems (e.g., valid parentheses, nearest smaller element patterns).

Round 3: Advanced DSA / CP

- CP-style problem
- Tested logical reasoning and ability to implement an efficient solution under time constraints.

NEO WEALTH AND ASSET MANAGEMENT



Personal Views

- **Systems & OOPs Knowledge:** Have strong fundamentals in OS, Networks, Parallel Programming, and OOPs.
- **CV Mastery:** Be fully confident about every point on your CV, including related concepts.
- **Handling Unknowns:** Ask for hints politely and demonstrate problem-solving ability.
- **Revision & Practice:** Revise OS, Networks, and OOPs thoroughly; practice Brainstellar puzzles across all levels.
- **Attitude:** Stay confident and positive throughout the interview process.

Profiles Offered

Finance / Wealth and Asset Management
(High-Frequency Trading / Mid-Frequency Trading focus)

Shortlist Criteria

- A minimum CGPA of 7.5 was reported for shortlisting

Preparation Resources

- **DSA Preparation:** Striver's A2Z problem sheet for Data Structures and Algorithms.
- **Systems and Core Concepts:** Revision of lecture notes for Operating Systems (OS), Parallel Programming, Networks, and Algorithms & Data Structures (ADA).
- **Quantitative/Puzzles:** Solved easy and medium questions from Brainstellar.
- **C++ MCQs:** Solved Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs) for C++ from GeeksforGeeks (GFG).

Selection Procedure

- Two rounds of interviews were conducted, each lasting approximately 1 hour.
- **Round 1 (Technical):** Focused on a combination of coding, core systems, and C++.
- **Coding:** Candidates were asked to solve a LeetCode medium-level question.
- **Core Concepts:** Extensive questions on Operating Systems, Parallel Programming, Networks, and C++.
- **Implementation:** Asked to implement basic C++ templates.
- **Round 2 (Technical/Conceptual):** Continued the focus on core and C++ but with more conceptual depth.
- **C++ and Data Structures:** Detailed questions on pointers and their uses, and deep dives into concepts like HashMap and other data structures.
- **System Concepts:** Further questions on Operating System concepts.

LINKEDIN



Personal Views

Anonymous

B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering

The best advice is to pick one good resource and follow it thoroughly instead of switching between multiple sources. Jumping between platforms often leads to shallow understanding and gaps in concepts.

More importantly, consistency matters far more than intensity; regular practice over time builds strong fundamentals and confidence. Set realistic goals, practice daily, revise concepts frequently, and focus on understanding why a solution works rather than memorizing it. Staying disciplined and trusting the process makes a significant difference in long-term preparation.

Vertical

- IT/Software
- Software Engineering Intern

Shortlist Criteria

- No explicit hard CGPA criteria was mentioned.

Preparation Resources

- **Striver's A2Z DSA Sheet**
- **CSES Problem Set**
- **InterviewBit** are recommended for preparation.

Selection Procedure

Online Test :

The first round consisted of 2–3 moderately to difficult DSA questions. These problems evaluated problem-solving ability, logical reasoning, and understanding of fundamental algorithmic concepts. Effective time management and accuracy were crucial at this stage.

Interviews (2 Rounds)

Round 1 – Technical (45 minutes)

This round assessed core programming and problem-solving skills through two DSA problems.

- One problem involved finding the minimum range by selecting one element from k sorted arrays.
- The second was a simpler problem related to string anagrams.
- Candidates were expected to clearly explain their logic, approach, and edge-case handling.

Round 2 – HR / Personal

The final round focused on projects listed in the CV along with basic HR questions. It aimed to evaluate communication skills, confidence, clarity of career goals, and overall fit.

MICROSOFT



Personal Views

- Develop strong DSA fundamentals through regular problem-solving.
- Practice communicating your thought process clearly while coding—explain each step logically rather than rushing to the final answer.
- Keep your CV well-structured with relevant projects that demonstrate practical application of your technical skills.
- Prepare for behavioral questions and know your projects inside out—interviewers often dive deep into implementation details.
- Stay composed during the interview—approach and clarity often matter more than the final code.

Vertical

Software Development

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7.0 (Hard Criteria)**

Preparation Resources

1. Primary Platforms:
2. LeetCode – for coding practice and company-tagged questions.
3. CSES Problem Set – to strengthen fundamentals and logic-building.
4. Striver's SDE Sheet – to cover all key data structures and algorithms.
5. Intern Prep Series organized by DevClub, IIT Delhi, was also extremely useful.
6. Key Topics to Focus On:
 - Arrays, Strings, Trees, Graphs, BFS/DFS, Dynamic Programming (especially 2D/3D-DP problems).

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Online Assessment (OA)

- **Duration: 1 hour**
- **Number of Questions: 2**
- **Difficulty:**
 - 1 easy problem
 - 1 easy-to-medium problem
- **Topics covered:**
 - Arrays
 - Dynamic Programming
- **Example problem:**
 - Finding the longest substring of one string that is a subsequence of another.
- **Each candidate receives a unique question set.**

Stage 2: Technical + Behavioral Interview

- **Mode: Online**
- **Duration: 30–40 minutes**
- **Structure:**
 - CV discussion and behavioral questions
 - 2 live coding problems:
 - Array manipulation
 - BFS + Dynamic Programming based problem
- **Evaluation focused on clarity of thought, problem-solving approach, and communication, not just final answers.**

SALESFORCE



Personal Views

- Be technically strong in DSA; Dedicating 8–9 hours per day during summers to build depth and speed.
- Maintain genuine projects that show clear effort and conceptual understanding, rather than superficial work.
- Communicate clearly even if you are on the backfoot; articulate your reasoning instead of going silent.
- For behavioral rounds, deep introspection helps. Don't fake answers; honesty and self-awareness are valued more than rehearsed responses.
- Ensure good balance between technical depth and soft skills; both were crucial in Salesforce's final selection.

Vertical

**AMTS Intern (Associate
Member of Technical Staff)**

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: None**

Preparation Resources

1. LeetCode - focus on Trees, Graphs, Sliding Window, DP, and Greedy problems
2. CSES Problem Set – essential for structured DSA practice.
3. Codeforces – useful for strengthening problem-solving speed and applying DSA creatively.
4. AcodeDaily – <https://acodedaily.com/> – helpful for topic-wise categorization and modified problem practice.
5. Peer GitHub Repositories – especially IITD student-run DSA and SDE prep collections.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Online Assessment (HackerRank)

- Duration: 90 minutes
- Structure:
 - 3 coding questions
 - Topics: Tree DP, Graphs, Arrays
- Difficulty ranges from medium to hard.
- Focus on algorithmic thinking and efficiency.

Stage 2: Online Technical Interview

- Mode: Google Meet + Hackerrank CodePair
- Structure:
 - 2 live coding questions
 - Topics: Sliding Window, Greedy Intervals
- Evaluation focused on approach clarity, live coding, and communication.

Stage 3: Salesforce Tech Accelerator (Final Round – Hyderabad)

- Format: 3-day fully funded on-site event

Day 1

- Arrival, networking, gala dinner

Day 2

- Office tour, tech demos, Salesforce overview

Day 3

- Final interviews and departure

Final Interview Details

- Mode: In-person whiteboard interview
- Duration: ~1 hour

Technical Focus

- CV-based deep dive:
 - ML projects (KMeans, DBSCAN, Adjusted Rand Index)
 - Connecting BFS traversal with clustering logic
 - Relevance of mathematics background for SDE roles

Behavioral / Techno-Managerial

- Leadership and teamwork
- Handling difficult peers
- Addressing introspective questions on career interests
- Open-ended prompts (e.g., converting a project into a business idea)

DE SHAW INDIA PVT. LTD.



DE Shaw & Co

Personal Views

- **Interview Confidence:** Answer questions confidently to leave a strong impression.
- **CV Readiness:** Be prepared to explain every point on your CV clearly and in depth.
- **Consistent Preparation:** Practice regularly to improve skills and boost confidence for placements.
- **Placement Mindset:** Stay calm, positive, and aware while making informed career decisions.

Positions Offered

- **Technology Developer Intern**

Shortlist Criteria

- **For Online Test:** Minimum **7.0 CGPA** for Computer Science branches and **8.0 CGPA** for all other branches, with no current backlogs.
- **For Interviews:** No hard CGPA criteria; selection is primarily based on performance in previous rounds.

Preparation Resources

Resources

- **Software / CS Prep:**
 - CSES Problem Set (Sorting & Searching, DP, Graphs, Striver's SDE Sheet, Competitive Programmer's Handbook, C++ Fundamentals)
- **Quant Prep (if interested):**
 - QuantGuide
 - *50 Challenging Problems in Probability*

Selection Procedure

- **Stage 1- Tests**
 - CV/CGPA shortlisting is the first step.
 - Online Test (HackerRank):
 - Duration: 80 minutes
 - Structure: 3 individually timed coding questions.
 - **Key Differentiators:**
 - Accuracy: Write clean, bug-free code to pass all edge cases without getting stuck in debugging.
 - Composure: Stay calm under time pressure. Panicking can lead to mistakes even if you know the solution.
- **Interviews (2 rounds)**
 - **Technical Round 1:**
 - Started with a detailed CV review.
 - **Problem-Solving:** A system design-style question involving document snapshots, which was first solved with a map and then optimized through discussion.
 - **Core CS Concepts:** Follow-up questions on the internal implementation of maps (hashing) and OS concepts like page replacement techniques.
- **Technical Round 2:**
 - **OOPS Design:** Design an Airline Booking System, discussing classes and structure.
 - **Concurrency:** Follow-up questions on handling parallel bookings (multi-threading vs. multi-processing).
 - **CP-Style Problem:** A competitive programming flavored question (approx. Codeforces Div 2 B level).
 - **Core CS Concepts:** Questions on OS concepts like "thrashing" and C++ fundamentals like the difference between a copy constructor and an assignment operator.

SAMSUNG KOREA



Personal Views

Himanshu

B.Tech, Mathematics and Computing

The coding problem was straightforward, but preparation is still important. Focus on **DP, graphs, and trees**, and include **data-structure-centric projects** in your CV. Be prepared to explain every project in depth.

Profiles Offered

Vertical: Software / Core Engineering

Role Offered: Associate Engineer

Shortlist Criteria

A **minimum CGPA cutoff of 8.5** was applied **before any other stage**.

Preparation Resources

- **DSA / CP:**
 - Striver Sheet
 - CP-31 Sheet
 - Codeforces
 - CSES
- **Core CS & Institute Material:**
 - COL106 Notes
 - IIT Delhi Intern Prep Series (DevClub GitHub)

Selection Procedure

Shortlisting:

- Candidates with **CGPA ≥ 8.5** were shortlisted first
- CV screening was done after meeting the CGPA cutoff

Online Test (180 minutes):

- Conducted on **Samsung's proprietary platform** (not compatible with macOS)
- Consisted of **one coding question** based on **DFS/BFS traversal**
- Difficulty level: *Moderate* (solvable in ~90 minutes)
- **50 hidden test cases**
- Only **10 submission attempts** allowed (sample test runs excluded)
- Evaluation was based on:
 - Time taken to solve the problem
 - CGPA
 - CV strength

Interviews (2 rounds)

- **Round 1 (HR | 20–25 minutes):**
 - Behavioral and fit-based questions
 - Motivation for joining Samsung and working in **South Korea**
 - Discussion on academic background, especially **Mathematics & Computing**
 - Personality-based questions (e.g., how parents would describe you)
 - Food preferences (veg/non-veg)
 - Light CV discussion
- **Round 2 (Technical | 25–30 minutes):**
 - Began with a **reading + analysis task**:
 - A technical passage on **Hardware Abstraction Layer (HAL)**
 - 8 minutes to read and make notes
 - Follow-up conceptual and critical questions
 - CV-based technical questions, mainly on:
 - **Binary Trees**
 - **Hashmaps**
 - Project-related discussion (strong understanding expected)
 - **No live coding** in this round

SONY JAPAN



Personal Views

Sitender

B.Tech, Mathematics and Computing

Build strong fundamentals in **Linux, operating systems, and coding**. Be very clear about anything you mention in your essay or CV, as interviewers will go deep into it. If asked something unfamiliar, stay honest and connect it to what you already know. Showing genuine interest like explaining how your curiosity started leaves a strong impression.

Profiles Offered

Vertical: Software / Embedded Systems

Role Offered: Software Engineer (Embedded Linux Software Development)

Shortlist Criteria

No Hard CGPA Criteria

Preparation Resources

Linux / OS:

- YouTube (Linux and OS basics)
- *Linux Basics for Hackers* (book)

DSA / Coding:

- LeetCode
- Coding Ninjas
- Striver A2Z DSA Sheet (TakeUForward)

Playlists: (Any one playlist was sufficient)

- CodeHelp (Love Babbar) – DSA
- Striver A2Z DSA Course

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Essay Submission

- Candidates had to write an essay describing:
 - Background and interests
 - Technical skills
 - Motivation and learning journey
- The essay focused on personal interests, technical confidence, and curiosity.
- Strong emphasis on **Linux knowledge, OS exposure, and cybersecurity interest**.

Stage 2: Interview (45–60 minutes)

- Although two rounds were shown on the portal, **only one interview round** was conducted.
- The interview was primarily based on:
 - Projects and points mentioned in the essay
 - Technical skills and confidence in them
- Topics discussed included:
 - **Linux basics**
 - Preference for **Garuda Linux**
 - Operating systems and **kernel-related concepts**
 - Cybersecurity background and how the interest developed
- Some **out-of-the-box questions** were asked to test thinking and learning approach.
- No live coding questions were asked.



Personal Views

- Solve a good variety of problems on platforms like LeetCode and CSES.
- For every problem, think about how you can improve the time and space complexity of your solution.
- When the interviewer asks if you have any questions, it is good practice to have some prepared.
- Before the interview, research the company and have a basic understanding of the role you are applying for.
- The ability to clearly explain the ideas and logic you are using to implement your solutions is a key factor.

Profiles Offered

**Software Development Engineer (SDE)
Intern**

Shortlist Criteria

- **A high CGPA of 9.0+ was required for shortlisting.**

Preparation Resources

- Practice Platforms: CSES problem set, LeetCode 150, Codeforces contests.

Selection Procedure

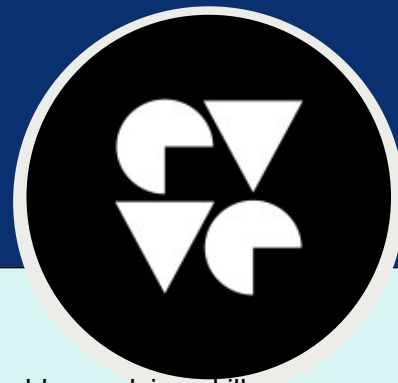
Stage 1 - CV/CG Shortlisting

- The first step is shortlisting based on CV and a high CGPA.

Stage 2 - Interviews (3 rounds)

- **Technical Round 1 (approx. 45 mins):**
 - The interview focused on DSA, with a question on binary search in a 2D grid.
- **Technical Round 2 (approx. 45 mins):**
 - This round involved more detailed questions on graph traversal algorithms like DFS and BFS.
 - It also included several variations of a question on searching within a grid.
- **HR Round:**
 - This round involved a detailed explanation of one project from the CV.
 - It also included general questions about the CV.
 - The interviewer provided an opportunity for the candidate to ask questions.

DEVREV



Personal Views

- Practice Competitive Programming (CP) regularly to strengthen problem-solving skills.
- Learn and apply Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) concepts thoroughly.
- Work on impactful personal projects if course projects are not strong enough, as projects play a crucial role in interviews.

Profiles Offered

- Software Engineering Intern

Shortlist Criteria

A minimum CGPA of 7.5 was required at the time of application.

Preparation

- **Practice Platforms:** cses.fi, codeforces.com, leetcode.com
- **Algorithms & Concepts:** cp-algorithms.com
- **Campus Resources:** DevClub IITD Intern Prep Series
- Strong understanding of DSA concepts and the ability to explain logic clearly.
- In-depth knowledge of your projects, including models, algorithms, and implementation details.

Selection Procedure

Written Tests

Online Test: The first step was an on-campus online test.

- **Structure:** 3 medium-difficulty questions.
- **Duration:** 1–1.5 hours.
- Shortlisting for the interview was based on test performance.

Interviews

2 Rounds

- **Interviews (2 rounds)**
- **Round 1 (Technical):**
- Began with a brief self-introduction, followed by a discussion of DSA and projects.
- DSA Questions:
- Implement a queue using n stacks.
- Given a numeric string and an integer k, remove at most k digits to obtain the smallest possible number.
- Round 2 (Technical):
- Focused on an in-depth discussion of two projects from the CV.
- DSA Question:
- Implement a stack with history functionality, allowing queries to retrieve the top element of the stack from its state (n–i) steps ago.

FLIPKART



Personal Views

- Focus your DSA preparation on Graphs and Dynamic Programming (DP), as these topics are frequently asked in both tests and interviews.
- Watch mock software engineering interviews on YouTube to get a better understanding of how to structure your answers and manage the interview flow.
- Communicate During Coding: While solving a problem in an interview, continuously explain your thought process to keep the interviewer engaged and on the same page.
- Know Your Projects: Be able to explain the projects on your CV in great detail.

Profiles Offered

Software Engineering

Shortlist Criteria

- CGPA: 7.5

Preparation Resources

- DSA: Striver's SDE sheet and the CSES problem set are highly recommended.
- CS Fundamentals: GeeksforGeeks (GFG) for selective reading on core topics.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1 - Written Tests

- **Online Test:**
 - Structure: 3 DSA questions. The difficulty was mixed, with 2 basic questions and 1 very difficult question (e.g., geometry-based).
 - Duration: 1.5 hours.

Stage 2 - Interviews (2 rounds)

- **Round 1 (Technical - approx. 45 mins):**
 - The round focused heavily on the projects mentioned in the CV.
 - Questions were asked about contributions to open-source projects and GitHub activity.
 - DSA Questions: Included implementing an LRU Cache and a binary search problem.
 - Core CS: Included questions on computer architecture.
- **Round 2 (HR Round - approx. 45 mins):**
 - This round was a mix of technical and HR topics.
 - Discussion centered on the details of team projects.
 - CS Fundamentals: Questions on topics like how code actually runs and Object-Oriented Programming (OOPS).
 - It concluded with some basic HR questions.

PATTERN TECHNOLOGY PRIVATE LIMITED



Personal Views

- The internship experience mentioned in your CV plays a crucial role; interviewers often ask in-depth technical questions about the technologies listed, not just your project outcomes.
- Avoid listing projects or tools you are not confident about; expect the interviewer to grill on any CV point.
- For an SDE role, include development-based projects that reflect your coding and design experience.
- Focus deeply on DSA and SQL fundamentals, as both are heavily tested.
- Be prepared to discuss why you like problem-solving and how it connects to real-world software work.

Vertical

Software Development

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7.5**

Preparation Resources

1. **Striver's DSA Sheet**
2. LeetCode Problems – for DSA and debugging practice.
3. LeetCode SQL 50 Set – for SQL query preparation.
4. **Candidate's Shared Notes / Experience Doc**

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Technical Interview

- **Type: Single technical round**
- **Focus Areas:**
 - CV Projects: Detailed discussion on internships and projects.
 - OOPs: Class design, abstraction, and core object-oriented concepts.
 - Debugging: 2 medium-level debugging problems.
 - SQL: 2 medium-level conceptual query problems.
 - DSA: 2 easy-to-medium difficulty questions.
 - Backend Concepts:
 - JWT: purpose, generation, and storage
 - Express.js: endpoint definition and invocation
 - HTTP status codes
 - Intro-level system design

Stage 2: HR / Behavioral Interview

- Duration: ~30 minutes
- Nature: Conversational and reflective
- Topics Covered:
 - Self-introduction, strengths, and weaknesses
 - Learnings from first year of college
 - Motivation for choosing PCM
 - Self-evaluation and achievements
 - Interest in DSA vs development thinking (real-world linkage)
 - Balancing a Textile Engineering major with Computer Science interests



Personal Views

- The McKinsey internship process is highly case-interview focused, with strong emphasis on structured thinking, clarity of articulation, and composure under pressure.
- While there is no official hard CGPA cutoff, a CGPA of ~8.1–8.2+ is generally preferred, especially during CV shortlisting.
- Case preparation matters far more than theoretical reading. Performance is judged almost entirely on live problem-solving ability.
- Once shortlisted, everyone is evaluated at the same level; your CV only gets you through the door, not the offer.
- Consistency, early preparation, and feedback-driven improvement are critical differentiators.

Profiles Offered

Business Analyst Intern (Consulting)

Shortlist Criteria

CGPA: No hard cutoff (Preferred: ~8.1–8.2+)

A “**decent**” **consulting-ready CV** is essential

Evaluation based on **overall profile suitability** for consulting

Preparation Resources

Video Resources:

- Case Interviews Cracked (CIC) – Recommended core playlist for overall casing
- Aaditya Agarwal – Strong for structured thinking

Case Prep Books / Compendiums:

- SRCC Case Compendium
- CIC Case Book
- IIM Ahmedabad Case Compendium
- IIM Bangalore Case Compendium

Mentorship:

- Seniors and Buddy / Partner Rounds for practice and feedback

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: CV Shortlisting

- First and critical filter
- Requires a solid, well-structured CV relevant to consulting

Stage 2: Buddy / Partner Rounds (Pre-Process)

- Conducted post-shortlist
- Includes:
 - Case questions (Guesstimates, Profitability, Unconventional cases)
 - HR / Fit questions
- Used to assess both case-solving ability and growth over time.

Stage 3: Final Interview Round

Final Round Structure:

- **Guesstimate Case**
 - Example: Estimating the number of coins in DLF Saket Mall
- **HR / Fit Questions**
 - Why Consulting?
 - Why McKinsey?
- **Questions for the interviewer**

Final evaluation focuses on analytical rigor, communication, and motivation.



Personal Views

- The BCG consulting intern role is heavily case-interview driven, with a strong emphasis on structured thinking, problem-solving, and clear communication.
- CGPA is not a hard cutoff, but CV shortlisting is extremely competitive, making profile strength the biggest differentiator.
- Resume quality matters more than anything else in the initial stages. Leadership roles, impact-driven work, and clarity of achievements are crucial.
- Adaptability during preparation (especially in Buddy Rounds) is key; rapid improvement based on feedback is closely observed.
- Make full use of seniors, buddy feedback, and structured case practice to stand out.

Profiles Offered

Consulting Intern

Shortlist Criteria

CGPA: No Hard Criteria

Strong resume with:

- **Leadership** experience
- Impactful **projects/internships**
- **Relevant** extra-curricular involvement

Overall **profile suitability** for a consulting role

Preparation Resources

- Case Interview Preparation (primary focus)
- YouTube Playlist: Case Interviews Cracked
- Books / Guides:
 - Case Compendium Book
 - Case Interviews Cracked Book
- Seniors & Buddy Rounds for mentorship and feedback.

Selection Procedure

- **Stage 1: CV / CG Shortlisting**
 - First and toughest filter
 - Evaluation based on academic background, leadership, internships, and extra-curriculars relevant to consulting
- **Stage 2: Buddy Rounds (Pre-Process)**
 - Started ~15 days before final interview weekend
 - Two buddies assigned
 - 1 case per week practiced with each buddy
 - Continuous feedback provided
 - Candidates assessed on growth and improvement over time
- **Stage 3: Final Interview Rounds**
 - Total Rounds: 3
 - **Round 1 & Round 2 (30 minutes each):**
 - 1–2 HR / Fit questions (5–10 minutes)
 - 1 Case Interview (15–20 minutes)
 - Focus on both behavioral fit and analytical thinking
 - **Round 3:**
 - Single HR question
 - Final evaluation of fit, communication, and motivation for BCG.



Personal Views

- Bain's internship process places very high importance on CGPA, with 8+ being almost essential and higher scores offering a clear advantage.
- The selection process is strongly case-interview driven, but equal emphasis is placed on business awareness and resume quality.
- CV shortlisting is consistently the most rigorous and competitive stage, making early CV planning is crucial.
- Candidates are expected to demonstrate comfort with real-world business thinking, not just structured frameworks.
- Interviewers often build cases directly from points mentioned in the candidate's introduction or CV.

Profiles Offered

Associate Consultant Intern (ACI)

Shortlist Criteria

CGPA: 8+ strongly preferred (higher is better)

Strong **consulting-focused CV**

Good performance in:

- Debating / Extra-curricular Activities
- **Scholarships** and **academic achievements**

Personal Essay plays a significant role.

Preparation Resources

Case Interview Preparation:

- Case Compendium
- IIM Bangalore Case Book

Video Resources:

- Case Interviews Cracked
- Victor Cheng (case interview videos)
- Briefcase Notion page

Business Awareness:

- Regularly watch Business Insider content to understand current business strategies and industry trends.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Initial Shortlisting

- Based on:
 - CV and CGPA
 - Online Aptitude Test
 - Personal Essay (used to differentiate candidates)

Stage 2: Pre-Interview Rounds

- Buddy Rounds and Hotlist creation.
- Used primarily for practice, feedback, and refinement.
- Hotlist prepared based on performance in these rounds.

Stage 3: Final Day Interview Rounds

Total Rounds: 2 or 4 (Varies by process/stream)

Detailed Account – 4 Rounds:

- **Round 1 (~20 mins):** Market Entry + Unconventional Case
- **Round 2 (~35 mins):** Market Entry + Guesstimate (often CV-linked)
- **Round 3 (~20 mins):** Profitability Case + Genuine Q&A
- **Round 4 (Partner Round, ~20 mins):** Behavioral / Fit only (no case)

Alternate Account – 2 Rounds:

- **2 Partner Rounds (~30 mins each)**
- Mix of case-solving and integrated HR questions.
- Fit and consulting mindset evaluated throughout.



Personal Views

- The most important things are your case-solving ability, good communication, and just being confident during the interview. My main advice is to do extensive case prep to get comfortable with the format. - Anonymous

Profiles Offered

Strategy& Summer Associate

Shortlist Criteria

An initial CV shortlist is conducted, with **8.0+ CGPA** being preferred.

Preparation

- Case Interview Preparation (primary focus)
- YouTube Playlist: Case Interviews Cracked
- Books / Guides:
 - Case Compendium Book
 - Case Interviews Cracked Book
- Seniors & Buddy Rounds for mentorship and feedback

Selection Procedure

Buddy Rounds

- After being shortlisted, you're paired with a buddy from the firm.
- Starts with an introductory call covering your background, motivations, and interest in consulting.
- Followed by a buddy case, which may be non-traditional (open-ended, creative, or discussion-based rather than structured).
- Acts as an informal evaluation of problem-solving, communication, and culture fit.
- Also a safe space to ask questions about team culture, projects, growth, and work-life realities.

Interviews (2 Partner Rounds)

- **Round 1**
 - This round includes standard HR questions ("Tell me about yourself", "Why consulting?") and a straightforward guesstimate case (e.g., "Estimate the monthly revenue of a restaurant").
- **Round 2**
 - This is more of a "fit check" round. It involves similar HR questions, unconventional problems (e.g., "Why are tin cans cylindrical?"), and broader strategy-based questions.

LEK CONSULTING



Personal Views

- The Investment Analyst role at WestBridge Capital requires a blend of structured case-solving, financial understanding, and strong soft skills.
- A minimum CGPA of 7.5 is required to clear the initial shortlisting stage.
- Beyond technical preparation, confidence and communication skills play a decisive role throughout the process.
- Real-world business understanding—especially through financial reports—is critical to performing well in discussions and interviews.
- A consulting-style CV format is preferred for initial screening.

Profiles Offered

Summer Associate Intern

Shortlist Criteria

- **No hard criteria, but an 8+ CGPA is considered safe for shortlisting.**
- **Almost everyone shortlisted had at least 7.5+.**

Preparation Resources

Core Case Prep : Finish the SRCC Case Compendium first. Supplement with the CIC YouTube series/book and the IIMA Casebook for industry context.

Structured Practice : Solve cases frequently with peers and seniors. Maintain a concise notebook for frameworks, feedback, and learnings. Create your own guesstimates/unconventional cases to sharpen structure.

CV and Personal Prep : Perfect your intro, know your CV thoroughly, and research companies well. Get multiple senior reviews—formatting and alignment matter.

CV Building : Focus on building a holistic CV with strong sections on scholastic achievements (Schols like SURA, DR, Forex are spikes), internships (aim for at least 2, one with a good brand name), and PORs/ECAs.

Selection Procedure

The process is rigorous, involving a multi-faceted CV review, evaluative buddy rounds, and up to five final interviews -

- **Stage 1: CV Shortlisting:** holistic review of the four standard consulting CV sections.
- **Stage 2: Buddy Rounds:** 2 buddy rounds are common, focusing on profitability, market sizing, guesstimate, and mathematics aptitude
- **Stage 3: Final Interview Rounds:** Total rounds typically range from 3 to 5, conducted by people from different positions
- **Round 1 (Senior Consultant/Manager):** Can be a light, easy-to-go case
- **HR Round (If separate):** walking through the CV, life, and interest in LEK
- **Senior Manager and partner round :** Focus on guesstimates, unconventional cases, and aptitude; expect interruptions, either a math-heavy profitability case or a conversational discussion on current topics, and possible on-spot offers.

WESTBRIDGE CAPITAL

WESTBRIDGE | CAPITAL

Personal Views

- The Investment Analyst role at WestBridge Capital requires a blend of structured case-solving, financial understanding, and strong soft skills.
- A minimum CGPA of 7.5 is required to clear the initial shortlisting stage.
- Beyond technical preparation, confidence and communication skills play a decisive role throughout the process.
- Real-world business understanding - especially through financial reports. It is critical to performing well in discussions and interviews.
- A consulting0- style CV format is preferred for initial screening.

Profiles Offered

Investment Analyst

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7.5 (hard cutoff)**
- Consulting-format CV
- Overall **profile fit for an investment and analysis role**

Preparation Resources

Case Preparation:

- SRCC Case Compendium

Financial Awareness:

- Company Financial Reports (annual reports, investor presentations, filings)

Soft Skills:

- Communication, confidence-building, and articulation practice

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: CV Shortlisting

- Initial screening based on a consulting-style CV
- CGPA and profile suitability evaluated

Stage 2: Group Discussion(s) & Buddy Rounds

- Combination of GDs and case discussions
- Example topic: Swiggy vs. Zomato (comparative business and market analysis)
- Focus on structured thinking, participation, and articulation

Stage 3: HR Rounds

- Total Rounds: 6 (overall evaluation stages)
- Discussions focused on:
 - Personal journey
 - Motivation for investment roles
 - Communication and cultural fit



Personal Views

- Aim to have 2 solid internships - ideally one in corporate finance and another in research finance (or both in the same stream done well).
- Focus on gaining practical exposure that translates into meaningful discussions during interviews.
- Make sure you can explain your projects clearly and confidently - the ability to communicate complex ideas simply is highly valued.
- Show genuine interest in financial concepts and the company's work.
- When asked for questions in the HR round, avoid generic queries (like "What's a day at AGM like?"). Instead, ask specific, thoughtful questions about their current work or focus areas.
- Expect long and intense interview days - "Be prepared for staying in the LHC from 8 AM to 9:30 PM on Day 1."
- Stay calm and confident - "You'll do great!"

Vertical

Consult

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA:8.0**

Preparation Resources

- Finance Fundamentals – Study core topics on Investopedia: bonds & fixed income, options (European/American), futures vs. forwards, insurance & reinsurance.
- Aptitude – Practice basic quantitative and logical reasoning (Hackerrank-style).
- Projects & Academics – Be ready to discuss all CV projects, especially finance, regression, or research-based work; revise linear regression, R^2 interpretation, and key assumptions.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Online Assessment

- Duration: 60 minutes
- MCQ-based aptitude test covering:
 - Logical Reasoning
 - Verbal Ability
 - Pattern Recognition
 - Probability
- Difficulty: Moderate, with adequate time for completion.

Stage 2: Role Shortlisting & Preference Submission

- Intermediate shortlist released based on test performance.
- Shortlisted candidates submitted priority rankings for seven internship roles.
- Final interview shortlist released post preference submission.

Stage 3: Interviews

- Total Rounds: 2
- Duration: ~25 minutes each

Round 1: Case Study & Problem-Solving

- Focus on structured and analytical thinking (no domain expertise required).
- Example cases:
 - Airport profitability issues
 - Declining red panda population in a zoo
- Evaluation based on problem structuring, questioning, and logical reasoning.

Round 2: HR & Behavioral

- Discussion on past internships, learnings, and challenges.
- Questions on:
 - Career goals
 - Motivation for a business role
 - Learning style
- Emphasis on communication clarity and cultural fit.

NOMURA RESEARCH INSTITUTE



Personal Views

- **Authenticity in CV Building:** Do not force yourself into activities or internships just to conform to norms. Be yourself and do what you like; the goal is to have an organic, compelling story to tell. Firms look for outliers identify and build on your unique separating factor.
- **Temperament Change (Non-Mechanical Approach):** Avoid being mechanical in interviews. Adopt a natural and logical approach.
- **First Principles Thinking:** Develop a habit of thinking about open-ended problems using first principles and breaking arguments down into granular, easy-to-follow segments, rather than solely relying on predefined frameworks from casebooks.
- **Maximizing GD:** In the Group Discussion, maximize your speaking time, structure your arguments logically, and do not interrupt others.

Profiles Offered

Summer Associate

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: No Hard Cut-off**
- Consulting-format CV
- Overall **profile fit for an investment and analysis role**

Preparation Resources

Case Preparation:

- SRCC Case Compendium
- Case Compendium

Profile Building:

- Focus on building a well-rounded profile covering the "5 sections of a consulting CV," coupled with a unique USP (e.g., consistent performance in sports/academics/extracurriculars) that sets the candidate apart.

Soft Skills:

- Communication, confidence-building, and articulation practice

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: CV Shortlisting

- This initial stage focuses on screening based on the candidate's CV and grades.

Stage 2: Group Discussion(s) & Buddy Rounds

- No Buddy Rounds/ GDs are conducted
- Attending the PPT is necessary
- Offers shortlisting based on the 4 types of investing Nomura operates in.

Stage 3: Case and HR Rounds

- Total Rounds: 3 (overall evaluation stages)
- Round 1: Case Component:
 - A guesstimate inspired by the CV, such as inspired by the candidate's USP.
- Round 2:
 - Focus: A business case with two parts.
 - A profitability or guesstimate case more focused on quantitative approach.
- HR rounds Discussions focused on:
 - Personal journey
 - Motivation for investment roles
 - Communication and cultural fit

KEPLER CANNON



Personal Views

- The Investment Analyst role at WestBridge Capital requires a blend of structured case-solving, financial understanding, and strong soft skills.
- A minimum CGPA of 7.5 is required to clear the initial shortlisting stage.
- Beyond technical preparation, confidence and communication skills play a decisive role throughout the process.
- Real-world business understanding—especially through financial reports—is critical to performing well in discussions and interviews.
- A consulting-style CV format is preferred for initial screening.

Profiles Offered

Summer Associate

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA:** No strict cutoff, but observed that candidates with a CGPA below 7 were not shortlisted.

Preparation Resources

Case Preparation:

- SRCC Case Compendium

Financial Awareness:

- Gain a basic idea about the startup world, financial statements (P&L, Balance Sheets, Cash Flows), and financial ratios (at least familiarity with key ones like NPV, Working Cycle, etc.).

Aptitude Test:

- Practice the sections found on the Aon assessment platform (sample tests are available on the site): Numerical Reasoning, Verbal Reasoning, Inductive Reasoning clx, Deductive Reasoning - gapChallenge

Soft Skills:

- Communication, confidence-building, and articulation practice

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: CV Shortlisting

- Basis: The CV was consulting-sort of, with prior experience in a VC firm and items highlighting interest in finance and economics acting as differentiators.

Stage 2: Online Test (Aon Assessment)

- Type: Primarily a speed Mental Ability test.
- Sections: Numerical, Verbal, Inductive, and Deductive Reasoning.
- Practice basic Mental maths and problem solving skills

Stage 3: Interviews

- **Rounds 1 & 2 (Combined Content):**
- Financial Fundamentals: Questions on basic financial knowledge
- Investment Thesis: Discussion on which sectors to invest in or which would boom, and how to decide between investing in A or B (using ratios/metrics).
- Startup/VC Knowledge:
- **Round 3 (Founder and HR Round):**
- Initial: A very light conversation with HR (if earlier rounds were good).
- Main: The round was taken over by Founder Vikram Gupta (IITD Alum).

IVYCAP VENTURES



Personal Views

- **Genuine Interest:** Having a great interest in business, startups, finance, and economics is crucial, as this is reflected both in the CV and during the interview.
- **CV Alignment:** Prior experience in a VC firm or other activities highlighting a genuine interest in finance & economics will make your CV stand out (CV was described as a "consulting sort of" CV).
- **Authenticity:** Don't be stressed about putting things in the CV forcefully; these interests are better visible in the interview rounds through confident and genuine discussion.
- **Confidence:** Maintaining confidence is key, particularly as the HR conversation in Round 3 is described as "very light" if the earlier rounds went well and the candidate remains confident.

Profiles Offered

Investment Analyst

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7 (hard cutoff)**
- Finance-format CV
- Overall **profile fit for an investment and analysis role**

Preparation Resources

Case Preparation:

- SRCC Case Compendium

Financial Awareness:

- Gain a basic idea about the startup world, financial statements (P&L, Balance Sheets, Cash Flows), and financial ratios (at least familiarity with key ones like NPV, Working Cycle, etc.).

Aptitude Test:

- Practice the sections found on the Aon assessment platform (sample tests are available on the site): Numerical Reasoning, Verbal Reasoning, Inductive Reasoning clx, Deductive Reasoning - gapChallenge

Soft Skills:

- Communication, confidence-building, and articulation practice.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: CV Shortlisting

- **Basis:** The CV was consulting-sort of, with prior experience in a VC firm and items highlighting interest in finance and economics acting as differentiators.

Stage 2: Online Test (Aon Assessment)

- **Type:** Primarily a speed Mental Ability test.
- **Sections:** Numerical, Verbal, Inductive, and Deductive Reasoning.
- Practice basic Mental maths and problem solving skills.

Stage 3: Interviews

• Rounds 1 & 2 (Combined Content):

- **Financial Fundamentals:** Questions on basic financial knowledge.
- **Investment Thesis:** Discussion on which sectors to invest in or which would boom, and how to decide between investing in A or B (using ratios/metrics).
- **Startup/VC Knowledge.**

• Round 3 (Founder and HR Round):

- **Initial:** A very light conversation with HR (if earlier rounds were good).
- **Main:** The round was taken over by Founder Vikram Gupta (IITD Alum).

REVOLUT



Personal Views

- Prioritize CGPA and internships when building your CV; these are often more impactful than ECAs, although some ECAs (like QLD) hold value.
- Stay calm and composed even if the interviewer seems standoffish; use 10 seconds to structure answers with: Statement → Reasoning → Intuition Pump → Example.
- Use humor sparingly to demonstrate interpersonal skills; interviewers evaluate “vibe” as much as technical ability.
- Be clear about the role you want and ensure your goals are communicated effectively.
- Learn from each round: Seek feedback, identify mistakes, and continuously improve for subsequent interviews.
- Leverage peer guidance and mock sessions if your own preparation is incomplete.

Vertical

Consult

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: None**

Preparation Resources

1. Case Preparation:

- CIC Case Compendium
- SRCC Case Compendium

2. Peer Support:

- Guidance from seniors with MBB/consulting experience.

3. Relevant Internships:

- Experience in VC, and EY internships helped strengthen case examples and domain understanding.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Interview Round 1

- Duration: ~25 minutes
- Structure:
 - Brief self-introduction
 - Case discussion

Stage 2: Interview Round 2

- Structure:
 - CV discussion and introduction
 - Case discussion
 - Discussion on company values
 - Situational judgment questions
 - Strengths and weaknesses

NAVI



Personal Views

- Integrity and adaptability matter as much as analytical ability.
- Example: admitting familiarity with a case during the interview and successfully solving a new one showed honesty and quick thinking.
- Reframe technical experiences as business problem-solving stories - demonstrate how your work added value or solved a client problem.
- Highlight self-learning ability - show how you've picked up new domains (e.g., Quantum Physics, Machine Learning) to solve practical problems.
- Maintain a clear narrative - know your goals, strengths, and why this particular role aligns with your interests.
- Participate in case competitions - they provide excellent practice and strengthen your CV.
- Build strong communication and case-structuring skills - practice explaining your thought process logically.
- Develop some general understanding of finance and fintech to discuss intelligently during HR rounds.

Vertical

Consult

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA:7.5**

Preparation Resources

1. Case Interview Preparation
 - Books – Case Compendium (SRCC alumni); one interview case was directly taken from it. Also refer to IIM Ahmedabad Consult Prep Book (2022–23).
 - YouTube – Case Interviews Cracked for frameworks and structured case-solving approaches.
2. Aptitude Preparation
 - Practice logical reasoning, verbal ability, and probability questions under strict time limits.
 - Focus on pattern recognition and quantitative reasoning via timed mock tests.
3. General Preparation
 - Revise past internships and projects with emphasis on problem-solving and business impact.
 - Prepare structured answers for common HR questions: strengths, weaknesses, motivations, and long-term goals.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1: Online Test (OCS Proctored – HackerRank)

- **Duration:** ~10 minutes
- **Total Questions:** 39
 - **Finance:** 10 easy questions (bonds, options); key differentiator for shortlisting
 - **Aptitude:** 29 easy questions
- **No coding component.**

Stage 2: Interview Round 1 – Finance & CV

- **Self-introduction followed by CV-based and finance-related questions.**
- **Topics covered:**
 - **Fixed income**
 - **Bonds**
 - **Options & futures**
 - **Regression (motive and assumptions)**
- **Candidates expected to discuss any project on the CV, not just highlighted ones.**

Stage 3: Interview Round 2 – CV Deep Dive & HR

- **Detailed discussion on one project (clear, structured explanation expected).**
- **HR questions included:**
 - **“Why should we hire you?”**
- **Ends with candidate questions; prepare 1–2 thoughtful queries.**



Personal Views

- Confidence plays a decisive role in the interview process. Staying calm, being authentic, and expressing your thoughts clearly often leaves a stronger impression than trying to over-polish answers.
- You don't need exhaustive case practice to perform well. What matters more is clear communication, honesty, and the ability to build trust with the interviewer. Strong speaking skills and comfort in conversation are critical—not just for consulting roles, but across interviews in general.

Profiles Offered

- **Associate Consultant Intern**

Shortlist Criteria

- **Resume shortlist was heavily CGPA-based**
- **7.5+ CGPA: Direct shortlist**
- **7.0+ CGPA: Waitlisted**

Preparation Resources

- Guesstimates practiced via YouTube and ChatGPT
- Prior exposure through case competitions

Selection Procedure

Group Discussion (GD)

- Format: 2 + 8
 - 2 minutes preparation
 - 8 minutes discussion
 - 30 seconds per candidate for conclusion

Interviews (3 Rounds)

Round 1 – Partner Round (30 mins)

- Guesstimates
- Standard “Why Consulting?” questions
- Technical questions related to candidate's major
- Discussion on impact of AI on consulting

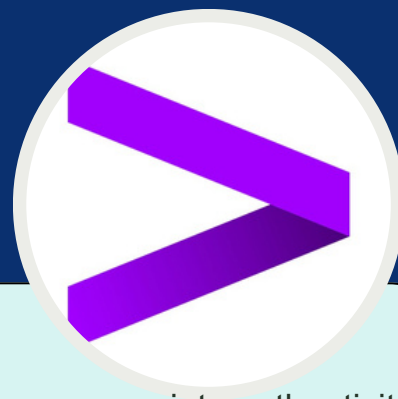
Round 2 – HR Round

- Teamwork and leadership experiences
- PPO willingness
- General HR fit questions

Round 3 – Technical / Case Round

- Deep dive into CV projects
- Detailed case study on market entry strategy for a luxury brand

ACCENTURE



Personal Views

- Be honest and confident during the interview - interviewers appreciate authenticity.
- Know your CV thoroughly; expect detailed questions on every listed item.
- Consult seniors for feedback on your CV and interview preparation.
- Maintain a positive and composed attitude throughout the process - confidence often makes a difference.
- Remember that preparation and self-belief go hand in hand: "Have faith in yourself and your CV."

Profiles Offered

Delivery Associate

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 6.5(hard criteria)**

Preparation Resources

- Practice aptitude tests focusing on general mental ability, logical reasoning, and grammar.
- Seek guidance from seniors who have appeared for the same role — their insights are extremely valuable.
- Prepare a document with answers to common HR questions, such as "Tell me about yourself," "Your strengths and weaknesses," etc.
- Conduct mock HR interviews with friends to improve communication and confidence.
- Keep your CV concise and honest, ensuring you can justify every point mentioned.

Selection Procedure

Written Test:

- Consisted of aptitude-based questions covering general mental ability, logical reasoning, and grammar.
- CV shortlisting may occur before or after the test depending on the stage.

Interviews:

- Typically 2–3 rounds.
 - Round 1: CV-based technical grilling — detailed discussion on every CV point.
 - Round 2: HR interview assessing communication, attitude, and company fit.
- Some candidates may face an additional case-based discussion in a third round.

NATION WITH NAMO



Personal Views

- A strong grasp of general knowledge, current affairs, Indian history, and policy-making is crucial. Beyond awareness, candidates are expected to connect real-world political and social issues with structured, analytical thinking.
- Interviews focus on depth over listing achievements. Clear thinking, logical reasoning, and the ability to draw meaningful insights from CV experiences are key.
- Preparation is similar to standard consulting interviews guesstimates and case studies with a political twist. A decent CGPA, regular current affairs prep, and confidence with curiosity go a long way.

Profiles Offered

- Consulting
- Political Consultant

Shortlist Criteria

- No hard CGPA cut-off
- Initial shortlisting based on CV / CGPA

Preparation Resources

Case Prep

- IIT Delhi Case Compendium
- Case Interviews Cracked (YouTube)

Current Affairs

- UPSC preparation channels
- Reputed news channels on YouTube

Guesstimates

- Regular practice recommended (core interview component)

Selection Procedure

Written Test (1.5 hours | Pen & Paper)

- 50 questions on GK & Current Affairs
- 50 questions on Aptitude & Logical Reasoning
- Essay aligned with political consulting
- 20 Comprehension questions

Interviews (1–2 Rounds)

- Duration: 20–30 minutes per round
- Basic CV discussion
- Guesstimate
- Case study (often political or unconventional)
- Strong focus on current affairs & general awareness
- Short HR round may follow

NVIDIA



Personal Views

Apporva Saraf (Electrical Engineering)

- Confidence matters a lot. Don't try to please the interviewer, be honest about what you know and what you don't. During the interview, they cared more about **how I think** rather than my final answers. Thinking out loud really helped, which naturally comes if you've done hands-on **Verilog coding**.
- Try to genuinely **love the subject**. Focus on understanding concepts deeply. Build a **good digital electronics project using Verilog** with originality, write the code yourself and start thinking in terms of **registers and wires**. Things get much easier after that.

Profiles Offered

Vertical: Hardware / VLSI

Role Offered: ASIC Intern

Shortlist Criteria

- CGPA cutoff was **not very strict**.
- It was around **7.0–7.5+**, definitely **not 8+**.

Preparation Resources

- A Google Drive folder containing **digital logic questions**.
 - (File: *DIGI_QS_FULLL*)
- Strong practice in:
 - **Verilog coding**.
 - Building **digital logic circuits**.
 - With hands-on experience, the preparation becomes much easier.

Selection Procedure

Online Assessment

Duration: 30 Minutes (High-intensity/Time-pressured)

Total Questions: 15

Content Breakdown

- Puzzles (4): Moderately easy; focused on logical reasoning.
- Coding (4): Moderately easy; likely focused on implementation or basic data structures.
- Digital Logic (7): Ranked as the most difficult section.
 - Key Topics: RAM, FIFO (2–3 questions), and general Digital Electronics.
 - Requirement: Requires a very strong grasp of core digital concepts to finish within the time limit.

Technical Interview

Duration: ≈ 1 Hour

Platform: HackerRank (Code pairing/Live review)

Test Review & Discussion

- Gap Analysis: Discussion on unsolved questions. (Note: Honesty regarding weak areas was well-received by the panel).
- Code Optimization: Defense of a "lengthy" but practically efficient solution.
- SURA Project: A detailed walkthrough of your Summer Undergraduate Research Award (SURA) project, focusing on your specific contributions and technical implementation.

QUALCOMM



Personal Views

APOORV SHARMA B.TECH,
ELECTRICAL ENGINEERING

- Just do core and puzzles. Don't think that Qualcomm gives less stipend. I had a couple of companies with much higher stipends, but Qualcomm, as shared by my seniors, gives a good working environment, a very high PPO chance, a good PPO package and other perks, which made me prioritise it over other day 2 companies who had much higher packages. You won't have to do specifically out-of-the-way things for this; just do all the basic core revision during vacations for all companies, and it won't take much of your time.

Profiles Offered

Hardware

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: No hard cutoff**
- Scores in the test

Preparation resources

- Basic course revision required
- Various scholastic achievements and the overall CV had a good impact on the interviewer.
- If you don't know a topic, state it directly.
- Solving a couple of difficult puzzles impressed the interviewer.

Selection Procedure

Online Test

One Test: Hardware or Software

- Topics are mentioned in the interview section, but also study a bit of transformer and microprocessor basics for the test. 20 questions come for aptitude, and 20 for electrical core or software if you apply for it.

Interviews

1 Round

- Single online interview; contained puzzles and maths so obviously do brainstaller. It contained core electrical engineering questions. Specifically focus on digital electronics. Understand working and basics of mosfets and basic circuit theory and analog. In digital both texas and qualcomm asked time delay questions. Have a good understanding of latches, flipflops FSMs and all the core digital concepts. Good scholastics have a nice impact.

TEXAS INSTRUMENTS



Personal Views

TRIPTI SAHU B.TECH,
ELECTRICAL ENGINEERING

- Your CGPA and test performance are the most important factors. Getting into external quant programs like the IMC Trading Launchpad also really helps and gives you something to talk about in interviews.

Profiles Offered

Analog Role

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7.5+ is preferred**
- Scores in the test
- **CV Shortlisting:** At any point

Preparation resources

- Strong preparation for the online assessment.
- Clear conceptual knowledge of my projects and the core topics.
- Practising aptitude questions helped a lot.
- Good communication skills and confidence played a big role.

Selection Procedure

Online Test

Three Domains: Digital, Analogue, and Embedded

In the test, you can choose any two domains for the OA. The test duration is 120 minutes, consisting of 30 minutes for the aptitude test and 45 minutes each for the two chosen domains. A total of 20 questions were asked in every part, making 60 questions in total.

- In Analogue, basic questions from ELL202, like filters and RC and LC conceptual questions, were there, along with some questions from systems and signals (Bode plot and stability criteria and good conceptual knowledge).
- In Digital, the complete ELL201 syllabus is important, as well as some gate-level questions specific to the digital domain.

Interviews

1 Round

- The Interview lasted for about 50 minutes for the Analogue role. The interviewer first asked questions about the project and then proceeded to technical questions. He asked about RC circuits and how the input and output waveforms would look for those circuits. Two different sets of questions were asked in this topic. He started with some basic questions and then gradually made them more advanced. Another topic he asked about was filters.

JAGUAR LAND ROVER TBSI



Personal Views

- To have a good knowledge of DSA, particularly on topics like Graphs, Trees, DP and arrays. Core preparation can also be done in the last 2-3 weeks, so avoid putting undue pressure on the core preparation. The main thing is to have a good knowledge of everything you are writing in your CV, so prepare your CV accordingly.
- Own your CV and present it clearly. Don't rely solely on CG/DR for success; focus on building strong fundamentals and staying balanced. Research the various companies visiting you for potential roles, as they all seek a mix of skills. Customize your HR answers to reflect your personality. Stay patient through challenges, believe in yourself; it only takes one opportunity to succeed.

Profiles Offered

- Powertrain
- Mechatronics
- Software Intern

Shortlist Criteria

CGPA: 6.5 (hard cutoff)

Scores in the test

Preparation Resources

- **For DSA:** Follow the Striver DSA Sheet and practice CSES questions on topics like Graphs, Trees, and DP. Being active in tech clubs and working on projects is helpful. Solving around 70 Leetcode problems across different data structures also strengthens preparation.
- **For Core Subjects:** Revise the topics taught in previous semesters. If you have not studied a particular topic, be honest with the interviewer instead of guessing or giving random answers.

Selection Procedure

Online Tests

Two Test

- Aptitude Test: Of around 40 mins - 60 mins having basic questions.
- Technical Aptitude (Core): The company offered three roles (Powertrain, Mechatronics, and Software). You were only allowed to give one test, which is higher on your priority list. (The powertrain role test included questions of control engineering, Digital electronics, and basic circuit solving).
- DSA: 2-3 easy/medium DSA questions.

Interviews

1 Round

- Started off with CV grinding: Asked about every project in depth, explaining all concepts involved.
- Core questions: Asked questions on course content and concepts relating to the role applied for.
- DSA: Asked easy-med DSA questions, required pseudocode
- (For Mechatronics) Case Study Round: A situation is presented; ask for a guesstimate. Then an HR round on where you see yourself in the next 5 years.

For Mechatronics Case Study:

- https://youtube.com/playlist?list=PLIUaT70ee0TZNudgN_IeHy35JmUSfsXhP&si=vCSGvotPpOOIGM8G

HINDUSTAN UNILEVER



Personal Views

Vaibhav Pandey - R&D (ULIP)

B.Tech

What helped me stand out was my **genuine interest in factories, chemistry, and how things work in real life**. Being articulate, staying calm, and clearly explaining why I was a good fit for HUL made a strong impression.

Be **practical and curious** about chemistry beyond textbooks. Understand how products are actually made, and have a clear idea about **HUL's vision, initiatives, and R&D direction**.

Garv Gupta : Supply Chain

B.Tech

What worked best was articulating my answers with business jargon and connecting deep research, like HUL's Minimalist acquisition to supply chain concepts. I built a strong self-intro that logically linked my skills to the role.

To succeed, do an in-depth background check, practice case studies, use the STARS framework for projects, and don't underestimate the HR round.

Profiles Offered

Vertical: R&D / Supply Chain

Roles Offered:

- R&D (ULIP)
- Supply Chain

Shortlist Criteria

- **No strict CGPA cutoff** was mentioned for either role.
- CV shortlisting was done based on **projects, CGPA, and application responses**.
- For Supply Chain, CGPA **above ~7.5** helped in CV shortlisting.

Preparation Resources

- **Common (Both Roles):**
- HUL website and background research
- **R&D Specific:**
- HUL R&D webpage
- *How It's Made* videos (shampoos, detergents, soaps)
- **Supply Chain Specific:**
- Business articles and reports (Outlook Business, McKinsey, BCG, etc.)
- Basics of supply chain management (YouTube, ChatGPT)
- Supply Chain-oriented case studies

Selection Procedure

Stage 1- Shortlisting

- CV shortlisted based on:
- Projects
- CGPA
- Application form responses (experience + problem-based questions)

Stage 2- Online Test

- **Psychometric and aptitude test** (behavioral, English, personality-based)
- **Online video submission:**
 - Prompt shown for **20 seconds**
 - **2 minutes** to record a structured response
 - Questions were role-specific (R&D / Supply Chain)

Stage 3-Interviews

R&D (ULIP)

- **1 Virtual Interview (~30 minutes)**
- Focused on:
 - Personality and motivation
 - Interest in R&D
 - Awareness of **processes, challenges, and trends in R&D**
- Questions included:
 - Why HUL?
 - Global challenges in R&D
 - Personal passion and interests

Supply Chain

- **1 Interview (~15 minutes | HR + Technical combined)**
- Questions included:
 - Tell me about yourself
 - Past internship experience
 - Discussion on a specific project
 - Favorite HUL product and why

PIRAMAL PHARMA LTD



Personal Views

STUTI UPADHYAY B.TECH,
CHEMICAL ENGINEERING

- If you are interested in core domain, you should try to complete atleast one project or internship related to this, try to take up research projects under professors of your department, and build a good CV. Prepare well for the group discussions with your friends, and go through the course content.
- Whatever you do, you must have the skill to present it really well in the interview.

Profiles Offered

Global Emerging Leader Intern

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7+ preferred**
- Score in the test

Preparation resources

- Review the course content and go through the lecture slides on key topics, including fluid mechanics, heat transfer, chemical reaction engineering, and thermodynamics.

Selection Procedure

Online Test

One Round

- Covered verbal & logical reasoning, and 50 MCQ questions of chemical engineering (mostly related to the course content of IITD). Each section was timed separately.

Group Discussion

1 Round

- Around 15 students were selected for this round, 2 groups of 7 and 8 people were formed. Topics of the group discussion were generic and not much related to chemical engineering, for example: Are humans controlling technology or is technology controlling humans?, Should indian government spend more on healthcare?. After the GD round 5 students were selected for the final interview.

Interview

1 Round

- GD was held on the day of the interview itself, which I have described above, so moving onto the final interview round. 5 students were selected for the interview which lasted around 30 min. Questions related to the CV were asked (if any project or intern in the CV involved any core knowledge, then questions/concepts related to that were asked), moreover, some HR questions were also asked.

MASTERCARD



Personal Views

- Try to build strong and impactful ML projects consistently throughout your academic years.
- Focus on building depth in Machine Learning and Deep Learning rather than just surface-level knowledge.
- Before the online assessments, revise and practice DSA properly.
- Good projects combined with solid domain knowledge make a big difference in technical interviews.

Profiles Offered

Data Science / AI-ML

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA Criteria: 7.5**
- **Eligible Branches: Up to Electrical department**

Preparation Resources

- Data Structures and Algorithms (Love Babbar DSA Series)
 - Machine Learning and Deep Learning
 - Studied ML and DL concepts in depth
 - Built multiple ML and DL projects
 - Projects
 - Self-initiated ML and DL projects
- One term paper project under the DE department based on deep learning models

Selection Procedure

Stage 1 - CV / CG Shortlisting

- CV and CGPA based shortlisting was done at different stages.
- The role was open only to students from departments up to Electrical, with a minimum CGPA requirement of 7.5.
- Online Test
- **Stage 2** - There was an Online Assessment consisting of three timed sections:
 - **Section 1:** Aptitude
 - 20 aptitude-based questions
 - Time limit: 12 minutes
 - **Section 2:** Machine Learning and Deep Learning
 - Domain-specific questions related to ML and DL
 - Time limit: 12 minutes
 - **Section 3:** Data Structures and Algorithms
 - 2 DSA questions
 - **Time limit:** 40 minutes
- The aptitude and DSA sections were quite lengthy and required good speed and time management.

Interviews (3 Rounds)

Round 1 – Technical

This round started with a brief introduction. Major focus was on CV-based discussion, especially projects. Questions were mainly related to Machine Learning and Deep Learning concepts, with strong emphasis on understanding and explaining projects mentioned in the CV.

Round 2 – Technical

This round included: One brain teaser question
General case scenario-based problem solving in the ML domain
In-depth discussion on complex and advanced projects
The interviewer was testing analytical thinking, domain understanding, and the ability to apply ML concepts to real-world scenarios.

Round 3 – HR

The HR round consisted of standard HR questions such as:
Personality-based questions
Why Mastercard
Career goals and interests

AMERICAN EXPRESS



Personal Views

- For data analytics in general-ML theory and brainstellar and SQL
- Study ML and consult type questions
- maintain a good cg (8+)
- practice consult-type questions.
- Look into what factors go into making a fraud detection model and how fraud is detected, as well as what factors might go into allowing an individual to use a credit card

Profiles Offered

Data Science/ AI-ML

Shortlist Criteria

- CGPA: 7.0

Preparation Resources

- For data analytics in general-ML theory and brainstellar and SQL
- ML can be studied from Coursera courses or YouTube

Selection Procedure

Stage 1- Test (60 mins): The test lasted one hour and consisted of multiple choice questions (MCQs). Topics included business mathematics, SQL queries, Python code snippets, machine learning fundamentals, and general aptitude.

Stage 2- Interviews (2 rounds):

- **Round 1 (Technical):** The first round combined both technical and strategic evaluation. Questions included basic Python and SQL syntax, ML project explanation, and a discussion on an AI-based internship. The interviewer also asked business-oriented questions related to credit cards such as how credit cards work, how credit card companies generate profit, and what factors can indicate fraud in transactions. Candidates were also asked to approach small guesstimates and puzzles to test analytical thinking and clarity of thought
- **Round 2 (HR):** This round was conversational, focusing on the candidate's understanding of the company and credit card domain. Some machine learning questions were revisited, along with strategy based questions like identifying cost components in a car advertisement company and suggesting ways to reduce customer service expenses. The round concluded with a "Why Amex?" question.



Personal Views

- The interview process is very structured and consistent across candidates. For Data roles, the technical interview is less about live coding and more about your ability to explain and defend the work you have already done. For BUK-ACE, your personality, logical reasoning, and problem-solving approach are more important than deep technical knowledge. The overall difficulty is considered average, but the process is thorough.

Additional Tips

- **Be thorough with your CV.** Be prepared to discuss every single line in detail. For **Data roles**, ensure your SQL, Python, and ML basics are strong. For **BUK-ACE**, focus on practicing situational reasoning and quick mental math.

Positions Offered

- **BUK-ACE Internship**
- **Summer Intern – Data Analyst**

Shortlist Criteria

- **BUK-ACE:** No specific CGPA is explicitly required, but a "good CG" is recommended.
- **Data Analyst:** A CGPA **above 7.0–7.5** was consistently reported as safe for shortlisting.

Preparation Resources

Resources

- **Aptitude / Psychometric:** Practice basic aptitude, logical reasoning, and situational judgment questions.
- **Technical (for Data Analyst role):**
 - **SQL:** Crucial. Expect detailed questions.
 - **Python & Machine Learning:** Be very clear with the basics and the theory behind the models used in your projects.
 - **Visualization Tools:** Familiarity with Power BI or similar tools is a plus.

Selection Procedure

- **Written Tests**
- Initial shortlisting is based on CV and CGPA.
- **Online Test:**
 - This is a mandatory step and typically consists of:
 - An aptitude and logical reasoning section.
 - A comprehensive psychometric or personality test.
 - Situational judgment questions, especially for the BUK-ACE role.
- **Interviews (2 Rounds)**
- **Technical / Situational Round:**
- **BUK-ACE (approx. 30 mins):** The interview is centered around **case-like situations**. Interviewers will present a problem and cross-question your approach and reasoning.
- **Data Analyst (approx. 15-20 mins):** The focus is heavily on your CV. Expect a detailed grilling on your **ML projects** and past internships. Questions will cover Python, ML basics, Power BI, and SQL.
- **HR Round:**
- **BUK-ACE:** A more traditional round. Expect generic questions like **"Why do you want to join Barclays?"** followed by a few **pen-and-paper math questions** to solve on the spot.
- **Data Analyst:** This round is typically **quite long and behavioral**. Be prepared for questions about past mistakes, significant contributions, and personal experiences.

EIGHTFOLD AI



Personal Views

- Solve as many coding problems as possible; there is no upper limit.
- Aim to solve at least 200–250 Codeforces problems up to 1500–1600 level.
- Try to complete the Striver DSA Sheet.
- C++ is preferred for interviews, though Python is also acceptable.
- Consistency in practice matters the most.

Profiles Offered

Data Science / AI-ML

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA Criteria:** ~7.5
- **Eligible Branches:** Mostly circuitual branches.

Preparation Resources

- Data Structures and Algorithms
- Striver DSA Sheet (target around 400–450 questions)
- Codeforces (CP31 Sheet, practice up to 1500–1600 rating)
- CSES Problem Set
- LeetCode (random practice)
- Brainstellar

Selection Procedure

Stage 1 - CV Shortlisting

CV shortlisting happens before the online test. According to the experience shared, mostly students from circuitual branches were shortlisted.

Stage 2 - Online Test (60 minutes)

Number of Questions: 2

Difficulty Level:

One Medium level question

One Hard level question

Overall level was around LeetCode Medium to Hard.

Good speed and problem-solving skills were required.

Stage 3 - Interviews (3 Rounds)

Round 1 – Technical

One coding question was asked.

Difficulty level was Codeforces 1200–1400 or LeetCode Medium.

The candidate had to write complete working code on the spot, pass all test cases, and explain each step and logic clearly to the interviewer.

Round 2 – Technical

This round was very interactive and fast-paced.

The discussion focused on applying logic quickly to different situations provided by the interviewer.

The interviewer was looking for instinctive thinking and clear reasoning rather than long pauses or overthinking.

Round 3 – HR

The HR round lasted around 20–30 minutes.

Basic HR questions were asked.

Personal Views**Krish Goel (B.Tech. Electrical Engineering)**

The interview questions were mostly basic and concept-oriented. For me, Andrew Ng's Machine Learning course covered almost everything that was asked. There can be deeper topics in Machine Learning that interviewers may ask about, but it is okay to clearly say that you haven't studied a topic yet and that you are willing to learn it.

Advice:

Complete the recommended resources properly before appearing for the test and interviews.

Focus on strong fundamentals in Machine Learning, Probability, and Statistics.

Do not hesitate to admit if you haven't studied a topic; honesty is appreciated.

With good preparation, the test and interviews become much easier.

Profiles Offered**Data Science / AI-ML****Shortlist Criteria**

- **No hard cutoff**
- **Selected candidates had CGPA of 9.09**

Preparation Resources

- Machine Learning
 - Andrew Ng's Machine Learning Specialization (3-course series) on Coursera
- Probability and Statistics
 - MTL106 course material
- What helped in standing out:
 - Good performance in the online test.
 - A strong scholastic section in the CV helped create a positive impression during the interviews.

Selection Procedure

- **Round 1 – Technical**

This was an online technical interview. Questions were mainly based on: Basic Machine Learning concepts, Probability and Statistics fundamentals.

- **Round 2 – Technical**

This round again focused on Machine Learning concepts. Questions included discussion on implementation aspects of Machine Learning models. The interviewer asked about implementing ML code using Google Colab, which required practical familiarity with coding environments.

- **Round 3 – Technical**

This round continued with technical questions on: Machine Learning, Probability, Statistics. Overall, all technical rounds were focused on testing fundamental understanding rather than very advanced topics.

- **Round 4 – HR**

The HR round lasted around 10–15 minutes. It included standard HR questions related to: Background, interests, motivation and career goals.

ACCERTIFY, INC.



Personal Views

- Clearly communicate your work and understanding during interviews, especially while explaining projects.
- Maintain a CGPA of at least 7.
- Keep learning AI/ML consistently, whether through YouTube or online courses.
- Try to build 1–2 solid projects to showcase your skills.

Profiles Offered

Data Science/ AI-ML

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7.0 (hard cutoff)**
- Final shortlisting depended on the pen paper test score.

Preparation Resources

Case Preparation:

- SRCC Case Compendium

Financial Awareness:

- Company Financial Reports (annual reports, investor presentations, filings)

Soft Skills:

- Communication, confidence-building, and articulation practice

Selection Procedure

- **Stage 1-Pen paper Test (60 mins):** pen paper test of 60 questions in 1 hr which had 20 questions of aptitude (cat dir quant like questions), then 20 not very hard mcqs on machine learning algos and finally some graph or pie chart based aptitude questions.
- **Stage 2-Interviews (3 rounds):**
 - Round 1 (Aptitude + Technical): Began with CV discussion and explanation of a DSA project, followed by two GFG-style puzzles and basic ML questions (bootstrapping, bagging, F1 score). Ended with a guesstimate where the approach mattered more than the final answer.
 - Round 2 (Technical): Focused on detailed discussion of DSA and ML projects questions on dataset sources, model accuracy, and improvements. Ended with a multiplex revenue guesstimate, which went very well and left the panel satisfied.
 - Round 3 (Director Round): Discussion on the company's work in fraud detection using ML. Questions revolved around parameters for detecting flight ticket fraud and possible improvements. Turned into a brief but intense grilling session, after which the offer was confirmed.

EXL SERVICES



Personal Views

- The projects that I worked on during my time at IIT Delhi helped me stand out during the selection process. Being able to explain these projects clearly and confidently during the interview was very important.
- Focus on doing meaningful projects during your time at IIT Delhi.
- Be prepared to explain your projects properly and in detail during interviews.
- Strong project understanding can significantly improve your chances of selection.

Profiles Offered

Data Engineering / AI

Shortlist Criteria

- **CGPA: 7.0**
- **CV / CG Shortlisting**
- **CV and CGPA based shortlisting was done at different stages.**

Preparation Resources

- Competitive Programming
- Regular practice of CP problems helped in building logical thinking and problem-solving skills.
- Projects
- Academic and self-initiated projects done at IIT Delhi played an important role.

Selection Procedure

Stage 1 - Online Test(Duration: 15 minutes Total Questions: 60)

- There was a short online test with the following details:
- The test included questions from:
 - Mental ability
 - Coding
 - Machine Learning
 - Artificial Intelligence
- The test was time-bound and required quick thinking and accuracy.

Stage 2 - Interviews (1 Round)

Technical + General Interview: There was a single interview round. The interview consisted of: Some technical questions, Some general and HR-type questions. The focus was on understanding the candidate's background and technical exposure.

AB INBEV



Personal Views

NIKUNJ MOHOTA B.TECH,
CHEMICAL ENGINEERING

- The AB InBev office in india (GCC, GAC) aims at using analytics/automation to reduce manual efforts in the company's operations across the world. Keeping that in mind is important. This does not mean you have to necessarily make ML models but basic analytics through excel would be expected (as is the case with MOST non-core companies).
- Being a beer company, the culture is one of the best that have heard which is also an important factor. Make sure to read about the company and its values before the interview!

Profiles Offered

Associate Data Scientist

Shortlist Criteria

Scores in the test

Preparation

- Basic placement preparation
- Company research

Selection Procedure

Written Tests

One Test

- Quant, LRDI, Verbal and two basic coding questions in any language. (Hardcore coding isn't a requirement for some profiles.)

Interviews

2 Rounds

- First Round: Group discussion based on a topic related to the company's brand's functioning in India involving basic strategic thinking. Example: Increasing sales of "XYZ" brand or making the invoicing process less manual, etc.
- Second Round: Your department/profile is not defined before and it is given based on your interests.
- Last year there were 2 different panels probably based on analytics and operations. Usually both will have a senior from campus and HR.
- Questions are based on resume, basic analytics or advanced ML questions based on the profile you're aiming to apply for and a few HR questions. An analytical mindset and reading the company values would be beneficial!



BSW

IIT DELHI

BLUE — — BOOK

BOARD FOR STUDENT WELFARE